



BOOK ONE

Operational Reports



Collective Bargaining In The
Digital Era

Building Trust

Managing Dispute

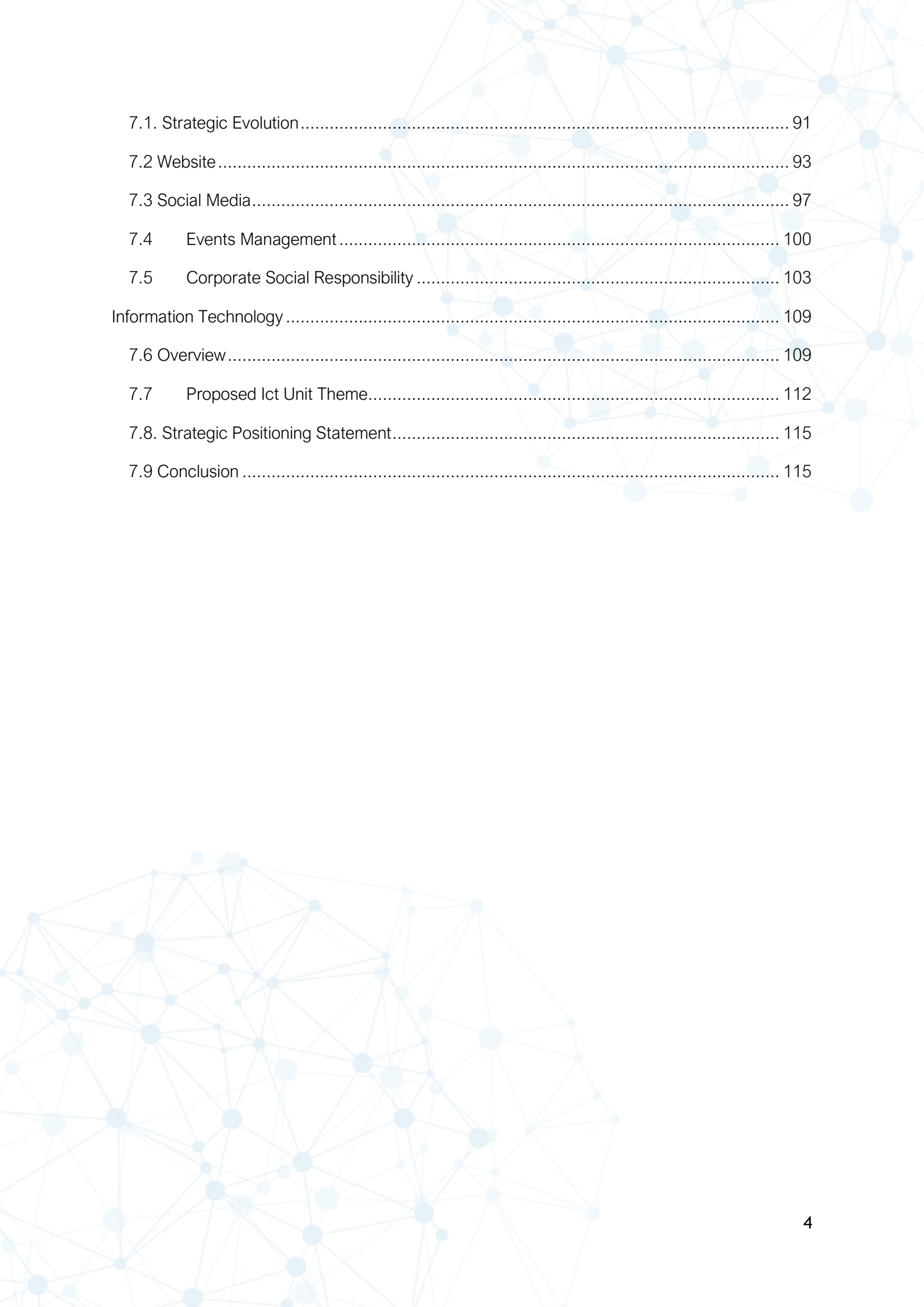
Ensuring Good Governance

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**MANAGEMENT
SERVICES**

MANAGEMENT SERVICES

1. Overview

The key strategic objective of the PSCBC Management Services is to manage the institution to ensure labour peace and sound labour relations in the Public Service, in accordance with the Constitution and the LRA. Management services further ensure an effective management of collective bargaining process, dispute resolution and prevention processes and provide a co-ordination function of sectoral and provincial bargaining structures in order to successfully accomplish the following:

- Sound relationships with stakeholders
- Establish links with national and international organisations in the field labour relations
- Promote labour peace in the Public Service and prevent dispute and enforce implementation of collective agreements
- Provide collective bargaining and negotiations support
- Corporate Services and Financial Management (Accounting officer of Council)
- Dispute resolution and prevention management
- Human Resources Management
- Communication and Information Technology Services
- Monitoring, Evaluation and Research
- Capacity building strategy to ensure representatives of parties and Secretariat are equipped with required knowledge and skills
- Attend and participate in meetings of the Council and the Executive Committee (EXCO)
- Effective management and strategy formulation and implementation for PSCBC Secretariat
- Co-ordination of Sectoral Bargaining Councils
- Co-ordination of Provincial Coordinating Chambers, and
- General Secretariat functions on behalf of the Council.

1.1 PSCBC Leadership Evolution: 2019-2025

The leadership of the Council underwent significant transitions during the "Re-imagined" strategy phase (2022-2025).

Financial Year	Chairperson	Vice Chairperson, Employer	Vice Chairperson, Labour	General Secretary
2019/20	Mrs. S.I. Dimo	(Vacant)	Mr. Casper Nanto	Mr. Frikkie De Bruin
2020/21	Mrs. S.I. Dimo	(Vacant)	Mr. Casper Nanto	Mr. Frikkie De Bruin
2021/22	Mrs. S.I. Dimo	(Vacant)	Ms KC Matome	Mr. Frikkie De Bruin
2022/23	Mrs. S.I. Dimo	Mr. Mompoti Galorale	Ms. K.C. Matome	Mr. Frikkie De Bruin
2023/24	Mrs. S.I. Dimo	Mr. Mompoti Galorale	Mr. Aubrey Zungu	Mr. Frikkie De Bruin
2024/25	Mrs. S.I. Dimo*	Mr. Mompoti Galorale	Mr. Aubrey Zungu	Mr. Frikkie De Bruin

**Note: Mrs. S.I. Dimo served until March 2025. Leadership for 2026 will be subject to new appointment.*

1.2 Executive Committee (EXCO) Membership (2020/2021 – 2025/2026)

Financial Year	Constituency	Main Member	Alternate
2020/2021	Employer	Nomsa Rilityane	Victor Sakala
	Employer	Maile Ngake	Johan Griesel
	Employer	Mmapitso Mashele	Sali Faker

	Employer	Louise Esterhuyse	Basi Malwane
	Labour	Simphiwe Gada	Thandeka Msibi
	Labour	Mompati Galorale	Shiyinduku Thwala
	Labour	Reuben Maleka	Basil Manuel
	Labour	Oupa Sibiloane	Thulani Ngwenya
2021/2022	Employer	Nomsa Rilityane	Victor Sakala
	Employer	Maile Ngake	Johan Griesel
	Employer	Mmapitso Mashele	Sali Faker
	Employer	Louise Esterhuyse	Basi Malwane
	Labour	Simphiwe Gada	Thandeka Msibi
	Labour	Mompati Galorale	Shiyinduku Thwala
	Labour	Reuben Maleka	Basil Manuel
	Labour	Oupa Sibiloane	Thulani Ngwenya
2022/2023	Employer	Mr. Mkhululi Mntuyedwa	Mr. Lesley Letsatsi
	Employer	Brig. Johan Griesel	Mr. Maile Ngake
	Employer	Ms. Mandisa Matyila	Mr. Basie Malwane
	Employer	Ms. Louise Esterhuyse	Ms. Thereza Swartz
	Labour	Simphiwe Gada	Matshidiso Dipudi
	Labour	Clement Marule	Zimisele Nanto
	Labour	Clause Naicker	Basil Manuel
	Labour	Thulani Ngwenya	Sebuti Masemola
2023/2024	Employer	Mr. Mkhululi Mntuyedwa	Mr. Lesley Letsatsi
	Employer	Brig. Johan Griesel	Mr. Maile Ngake
	Employer	Ms. Mandisa Matyila	Mr. Basie Malwane
	Employer	Ms. Louise Esterhuyse	Ms. Thereza Swartz
	Labour	Mr. Sean McGladdery	Mr. Given Mabuza

	Labour	Mr. Gregory Masondo	Mr. Basil Manuel
	Labour	Mr. Claude Naiker	Mr. Pat Mphela
	Labour	Mr. David Phala	Ms. Maipato Morake
2024/2025	Employer	Ms. Claudia Sekgoele	Mr. Modise Letsatsi
	Employer	Ms. Louise Esterhuysen	Mr. Percy Tshabane
	Employer	Ms. Mandisa Matyila	Mr. Andrew Makape
	Employer	Brigadier Johan Griessel	Ms. Beauty Chidi
	Labour	Mr. Sean McGladdery	Mr. Given Mabuza
	Labour	Mr. Gregory Masondo	Mr. Basil Manuel
	Labour	Mr. Claude Naiker	Mr. Pat Mphela
	Labour	Mr. David Phala	Ms. Maipato Morake
2025/2026	Employer	Ms. Mandisa Matyila	Mr. Lesley Letsatsi
	Employer	Ms. Claudia Sekgoele	Mr. Oscar Msweli
	Employer	Ms. Louise Esterhuysen	Mr. Mashego Mahlatjhe
	Employer	Mr. Hendry Collins	Ms. Beauty Chidi
	Labour	Mr. Sean McGladdery	Mr. Given Mabuza
	Labour	Mr. Gregory Masondo	Mr. Basil Manuel
	Labour	Mr. Claude Naiker	Mr. Pat Mphela
	Labour	Mr. David Phala	Ms. Maipato Morake

1.3. Capacity Building for Parties to Council

Over the past five years, the Council prioritised continuous capacity building to strengthen institutional effectiveness, enhance collective bargaining capability, and modernise dispute resolution systems.

Training and development initiatives focused on strengthening legislative compliance, improving negotiation and conciliation skills, and adapting to digital transformation within labour relations.

Early efforts centred on responding to regulatory amendments and pandemic-related adjustments, including the transition to virtual dispute resolution platforms.

Subsequent programmes expanded toward promoting labour peace, refining bargaining strategies, and advancing women's leadership through structured empowerment initiatives for negotiators. The Council also invested in digital skills development, including artificial intelligence applications, cybersecurity, and disaster recovery to enhance organisational resilience.

International engagement formed a key component of the capacity-building strategy, with participation in regional and global labour law conferences, study visits, and congresses. These platforms facilitated knowledge exchange, benchmarking against international best practices, and strengthening partnerships within the broader labour relations community.

Collectively, these initiatives contributed to building a more skilled, adaptive, and future-ready Council, capable of sustaining effective collective bargaining and dispute management within the Public Service.

1.4. Resolutions signed (2020–2025)

Between 2020 and 2026, the Council delivered a structured series of collective agreements that shaped remuneration, institutional reform, and governance processes within the Public Service.

The period was characterised by successive salary adjustment agreements, ensuring continuity in conditions of service while responding to changing economic and fiscal conditions. In addition, the Council strengthened its dispute resolution framework through the formalisation of panels and updated procedural rules.

Key milestones included the endorsement of the Public Service Summit Declaration, the integration of employees into the Border Management Authority, and the introduction of standardised enforcement mechanisms to ensure compliance with signed agreements. Amendments to prior resolutions and the referral of outstanding matters for further engagement reflect an evolving and responsive bargaining environment.

Overall, the cycle demonstrates sustained engagement between parties, reinforcing stability, accountability, and structured labour relations across the Public Service.

1.5 Provincial Workshops and Interventions (2020 – 2025)

From 2020 to 2025, the Council intensified its provincial outreach to strengthen alignment, improve labour relations, and promote inclusive participation across all chambers.

Strategic planning engagements were conducted nationwide to ensure provincial operational plans were aligned with the broader organisational direction. Alongside this, a well-being framework was introduced to support mental health and psychosocial resilience within provincial structures.

Targeted relationship-building initiatives were implemented in provinces experiencing heightened tensions, focusing on restoring trust and improving collaboration between Employer and Labour representatives. Complementary dispute prevention programmes equipped shop stewards and line managers with early resolution skills to reduce escalation to formal processes.

In advancing transformation, dedicated empowerment initiatives were rolled out to enhance the representation and effectiveness of women within negotiation platforms, contributing to a more inclusive and balanced bargaining environment.

1.6 Strategic Objectives for 2026

Collective Bargaining and Dispute Resolution: To strengthen the integrity, effectiveness and sustainability of PSCBC-led centralised collective bargaining and dispute resolution through enhanced social dialogue, interest-based negotiation, institutional capacity, legal certainty, compliance, and modernised dispute prevention in a changing public service environment.

Good Governance and Public Service Professionalisation: To strengthen good governance of labour relations in the public service by promoting transparent, ethical and accountable PSCBC processes, clarifying governance roles, strengthening relationship management and institutional sustainability, and advancing professionalisation, capacity building and skills development in alignment with the National Framework for Professionalising the Public Service.

Workforce Wellbeing and Transformation: To enhance public service workforce well-being through an integrated and policy-led mental health and psychosocial support framework that improves access to EAPs and related benefits, promotes safe and inclusive workplaces, reduces stigma, strengthens early intervention and resilience, and advances equity in employment, transformation and inclusivity in line with ILO standards.

Future of Work, Technology and Digital Transformation: To strengthen the future readiness of public service labour relations through an inclusive and rights-based digital transformation that enhances participation in bargaining and dispute resolution, leverages technology for effective governance and decision-making, manages digital and AI impacts, supports modern work arrangements, and builds skills, resilience and sustainability.

Sustainable Public Service Funding, Fiscal Framework and Wage Policy: To strengthen sustainable public service funding and wage policy through fiscal trend analysis, evidence-based budgeting, and predictable multi-year wage agreements that protect employees, support job security, and ensure stable labour relations and service delivery.

1.7 Conclusion

the PSCBC Management Services has played a critical and evolving role in promoting labour peace, strengthening collective bargaining, and ensuring sound labour relations within the Public Service. Through effective leadership, structured governance, capacity building, and the signing and enforcement of collective agreements, the Council has demonstrated resilience and adaptability in responding to changing labour, economic, and technological environments. Its provincial interventions, stakeholder coordination, and investment in skills development have enhanced institutional effectiveness and inclusivity. As the PSCBC moves towards its 2026 strategic objectives, its continued focus on good governance, workforce wellbeing, digital transformation, and sustainable wage policy positions the institution to remain a central pillar in fostering stable, fair, and future-ready labour relations in the Public Service.

The background features a complex geometric design. A central horizontal band contains a repeating pattern of green and white geometric shapes. Overlaid on this band is a large, dark blue, three-dimensional, curved shape with horizontal stripes. The top and bottom corners of the page are decorated with a network diagram of blue dots connected by thin lines, set against a white background with a subtle, larger-scale geometric pattern.

COLLECTIVE BARGAINING

COLLECTIVE BARGAINING

2. Overview

The Collective Bargaining Unit (CBU) serves as a core operational arm of the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC). Its primary purpose is to provide the administrative and research platform necessary for the Council and its various structures to negotiate and conclude collective agreements on matters of mutual interest within the public service

Strategic Evolution

- **Initial Objectives (2020):** The CBU focused on optimizing bargaining structures, ensuring compliance with agreements, and developing an organisational research strategy.
- **Structural Realignment (2024):** Under a new PSCBC structure, the Research section was moved to the Monitoring and Evaluation Unit. Then again, the CBU gained the "Management of Trade Union Membership" to help strengthen and defend centralized collective bargaining.
- **Strategic Shift (2024–2025):** Following a successful two-year salary agreement in 2023, the Unit shifted resources toward priorities outlined in the March 2022 Emperors Palace Summit Declaration. By 2025, the focus remained on promoting centralized bargaining and facilitating decision-making aimed at improving the public service

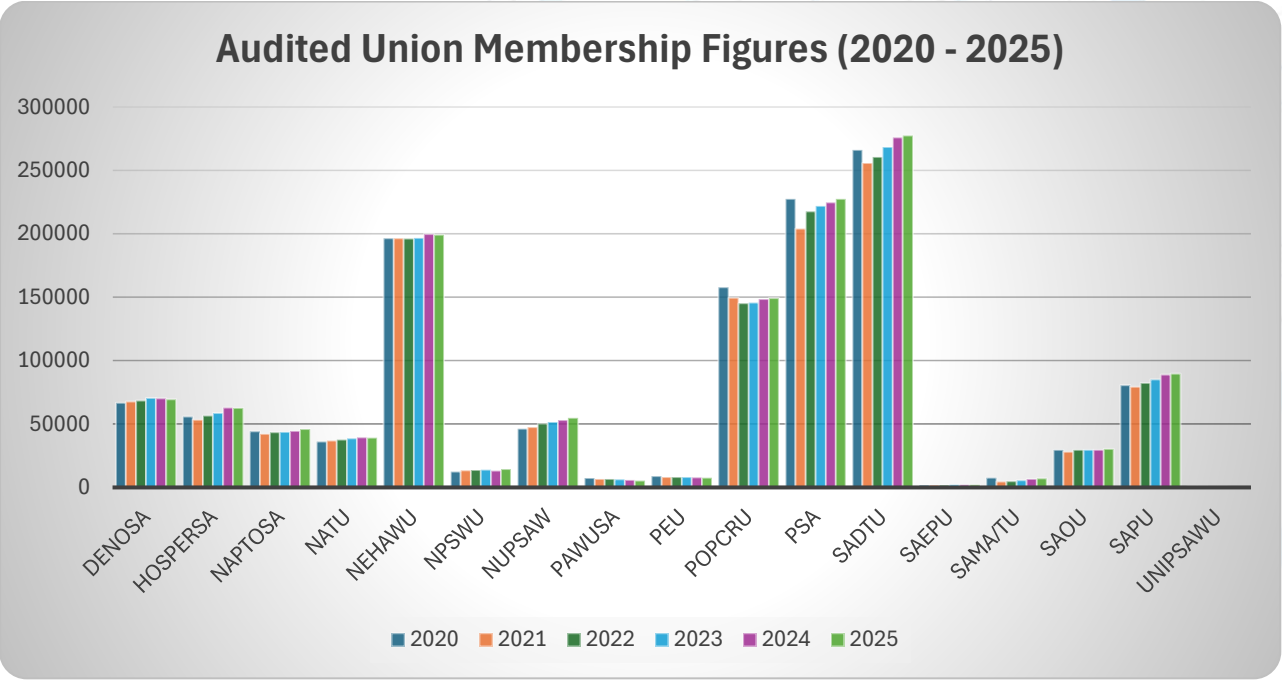
The report focusses on the following five pillars geared at promoting and advancing centralised bargaining in the public service:

2.1 Trade Union Membership in the PSCBC

The Council consists of eight primary unions representing 1.2 million employees, roughly 89% of the total workforce. Union strength and influence within the Council are directly proportional to membership size; a larger membership base translates to a higher voting weight. The current distribution of voting weights is outlined below:"

TRADE UNION	TOTAL	VOTE WEIGHT	REPS
DENOSA	69 461	6,57%	4
SAMATU	7 270		
PAWUSA	5 386		
SAEPU	2 143		
SUB TOTAL	84 260		
HOSPERSA	62 720	7,95%	5
NATU	39 298		
SUB TOTAL	102 018		
NAPTOSA	45 991	5,95%	4
SAOU	30 307		
SUB TOTAL	76 298		
NEHAWU	199 377	15,54%	5
SUB TOTAL	199 377		
POPCRU	149 291	11,63%	5
SUB TOTAL	149 291		
PSA	227 548	18,86%	5
NPSWU	14 518		
SUB TOTAL	242 066		
SADTU	277 642	21,64%	5
SUB TOTAL	277 642		
SAPU	89 661	11,87%	5
PEU	7 641		
NUPSAW	54 967		
SUB TOTAL	152 269		
Grand Total	1 283 221	100%	38

The following chart illustrates the total membership trends based on audited figures for the period 2020-2025.



The table below presents a comparative analysis of membership statistics for all PSCBC-admitted trade unions. It contrasts PERSAL data against the annual audited figures provided by the unions over the last five years.

A negative variance reflects an underestimation in the audited figures relative to PERSAL, while a positive variance indicates an overestimation in the audited figures compared to PERSAL records."

TRADE UNION	2021/2022 Audited Membership Figures	2021/2022 PERSAL Figures	2021/2022 Variance	2022/2023 Audited Membership Figures	2022/2023 PERSAL Figures	2022/2023 Variance
DENOSA	68672	67882	790	68584	68186	398
HOSPERSA	54234	53371	863	56743	55951	792
NAPTOSA	44019	42305	1714	43617	42027	1590
NATU	38014	37064	950	37691	36942	749
NEHAWU	196799	196470	329	196201	196201	0
NPSWU	13528	13488	40	13624	13571	53
NUPSAW	48222	47535	687	50250	49409	841
PAWUSA	7349	6625	724	6724	6176	548
PEU	8679	8171	508	8108	7894	214
POPCRU	151449	149592	1857	145190	143953	1237
PSA	215828	204038	11790	217632	207026	10606
SADTU	259447	255758	3689	260720	257314	3406
SAEPU	1883	1882	1	1958	1857	101
SAMATU	5683	4636	1047	4988	3855	1133
SAOU	29614	28069	1545	29516	28137	1379
SAPU	80789	79278	1511	82423	81270	1153
UNIPSAWU	764	742	22	624	604	20

TRADE UNION	2023/2024 Audited Membership Figures	2023/2024 PERSAL Figures	2023/2024 Variance	2024/2025 Audited Membership Figures	2024/2025 PERSAL Figures	2024/2025 Variance	2025/2026 Audited Membership Figures	2025/2026 PERSAL Figures	2025/2026 Variance
DENOSA	70548	69816	732	70332	69816	516	69461	69020	441
HOSPERSA	58732	57817	915	62839	62020	819	62720	62002	718
NAPTOSA	43711	42677	1034	44603	43022	1581	45991	44484	1507
NATU	38605	37654	951	39558	38511	1047	39298	38806	492
NEHAWU	196648	196304	344	199665	199665	0	199377	199377	0
NPSWU	14044	14083	-39	13222	13178	44	14518	14471	47
NUPSAW	51498	50667	831	53054	52349	705	54967	54765	202
PAWUSA	6476	5867	609	5903	5443	460	5386	4861	525
PEU	8099	7884	215	7904	7722	182	7641	7457	184
POPCRU	145882	144603	1279	148461	147018	1443	149291	147510	1781
PSA	222072	211223	10849	224697	213264	11433	227548	213533	14015
SADTU	268450	262722	5728	275979	269381	6598	277642	271319	6323
SAEPU	2005	1789	216	2044	1876	168	2143	2041	102
SAMATU	5660	4005	1655	6780	4425	2355	7270	4422	2848
SAOU	29658	28356	1302	29639	29639	1389	30307	29040	1267
SAPU	85200	83906	1294	88996	87852	1144	89661	88213	1448
UNIPSAWU	498	492	6	423	416	7			

2.2 Variance Explained (Audited Membership Figures vs PERSAL Figures)

Discrepancies in membership figures largely stem from how a member in "good standing" is defined. While the Council's constitution offers no formal definition of the term, individual union constitutions fill this gap, and the following are often the reasons for reporting variances:

- **Lapsed Deductions:** A member whose PERSAL deduction is cancelled may remain in "good standing" with their union until a specific notice period expires.
- **Employment Status:** Employees who are suspended, appealing a dismissal, or awaiting arbitration are frequently still counted as active members by their unions.
- **Administrative Lags:** Delays in capturing year-end applications (specifically those recruited in November and December) often result in unions counting members before they appear in official system records.
- **System Reliability:** The absolute accuracy of PERSAL figures is also subject to debate, given ongoing concerns regarding "ghost workers" within the public service.

Currently, the Council's constitution provides no mandate to verify audited union figures or PERSAL data. However, data integrity is vital to the spirit of social dialogue. Precise membership figures are the only way to accurately determine vote weights, which in turn dictate whether a majority has been reached for the implementation of agreements.

Ultimately, to pass a true "integrity test", the Council must have a direct role or substantial influence in how membership data is captured and authenticated. Since the 2019 strategic planning session, the PSCBC has committed to centralising membership administration. Following Council endorsement and a subsequent organisational restructure, a dedicated section was established to drive this initiative and support the advancement of unionism within the public service.

To facilitate a seamless transition, technical teams have engaged in focused consultations to map out processes, identify and mitigate potential challenges. Key focus areas throughout this period include:

- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Clarifying the centralized model for trade unions.
- **Compliance:** Ensuring all functions meet legal and constitutional standards.
- **Operational Framework:** Developing robust standard operating procedures.
- **Systems Development:** Building a bespoke membership management system.

While this remains a work in progress, the insights gained from ongoing engagements continue to refine the procedures necessary for effective implementation.

2.3 Proliferation of Trade Unions

The PSCBC maintains a strict legal and ethical obligation to treat all unions with consistency. Under Section 18(2) of the Labour Relations Act (LRA), collective agreements regarding membership thresholds are only legally binding if those standards are applied uniformly to every registered union seeking organizational rights.

A stop-order verification conducted by Council on 31 March 2020 revealed significant anomalies in how various unions accessed organisational rights. The following entities were identified as enjoying the right to trade union subscription deductions (stop orders) despite not being officially registered:

- Education Health Church Welfare and Allied Workers
- Progressive Trade Union of South Africa
- South African Agriculture Plantation and Allied Workers Union
- South African Democratic Nurses Union
- Staatsdiens en Aanverwante Werkervakbond
- United Association of South Africa

The following trade unions were registered and held certain organisational rights, yet lacked formal recognition under PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2017:

- Independent Municipal and Allied Trade Union
- South African ABET Educators Union
- South African Liberated Public Sector Workers Union
- South African Municipal Workers Union
- South African Correctional Services Workers Union
- South African State and Allied Workers Union

Council alerted the Employer to these discrepancies, initiating a corrective process across state departments. While largely resolved, the General Secretary remains mandated to defend this space against sporadic attempts by smaller unions to bypass established protocols.

2.3.1 Challenges of "Acting Together" Arrangements

The Council's constitution currently does not impose a membership limit on trade unions that choose to act together. This "*acting together*" arrangement only requires that the combined group or an individual union meets the established threshold for admission.

Consequently, this framework facilitates the proliferation of trade unions in the following ways:

- **Equal Rights for Disparate Sizes:** A union with only 1,013 members can enjoy the same organizational rights as a union with 254,549 members by participating in an acting-together arrangement.
- **Access Without Minimum Membership:** Admission is based on the ability to act as a collective rather than individual membership numbers; this allows a union with as few as 10 members to gain access to the PSCBC.

To fulfil the Labour Relations Act's requirement for fair and consistent conduct, the Council must strategically evaluate its admission requirements. This includes aligning the thresholds for organisational rights and standardising the process for granting stop-order facilities and subscription deductions. It is essential that the Council takes these steps to guard against union proliferation and maintain the integrity of centralised collective bargaining.

2.4 Compliance Audit and Enforcement of Signed Resolutions

A key milestone for the PSCBC during the current strategic period was the 2022 Summit on Collective Bargaining. This Summit resulted in a Declaration that was later adopted as Resolution 1 of 2022. Based on the four objectives of the 2019 Strategic Plan, the Declaration introduced a simplified implementation approach.

Under Paragraph 4.2.5 of the Declaration, the Council is mandated to audit compliance with signed collective agreements across all sectoral councils. Furthermore, Paragraph 4.2.6 required the Council to finalize enforcement procedures and ensure that sectoral constitutions include provisions for effective enforcement.

To date, the National Implementation Task Team (NITT) has conducted the compliance audit, and deliberations are ongoing. Additionally, the Dispute Management Committee has established a Resolution to guide the enforcement process.

In the reporting period, the PSCBC concluded and signed several resolutions arising from collective bargaining and stakeholder engagements.

These resolutions addressed conditions of service, governance, dispute resolution, and institutional strengthening, reflecting Council's commitment to constructive dialogue and stable labour relations within the public service, and are subject to enforcement processes.

Resolutions:

- **PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2020** - Agreement on the Amendment of PSCBC Resolution 5 of 2001 - Annual Leave
- **PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2021** - Agreement on the Payment of a Salary Adjustment in the Public Service for the Financial Year 2021/2022.
- **PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2022** - Adoption of the Declaration on the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council Summit on Collective Bargaining, held on 28-31 March 2022 at Emperors Palace Conference Centre, Gauteng
- **PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2023** - Agreement on the Transfer and Integration of Staff into the Border Management Authority
- **PSCBC Resolution 3 of 2023** - Enforcement of Collective Agreements in the Public Service
- **PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2024** - Rules for the Conduct of Proceedings before the PSCBC
- **PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2025** - Agreement on the Payment of Salary Adjustments and Improvement of Conditions of service in the Public Service for the financial years 2025/2026, 2026/2027 and 2027/2028
- **PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2025** - Agreement on Matters Referred to a Further Process for Research, Investigation and Negotiations in the Financial Year 2025/2026

2.5 Strengthening of Chambers

Provincial Coordinating Chambers serve as the vital engines of labour peace, fostering stability through structured dialogue. They ensure that the public service remains functional, fair, and transparent.

Chambers monitor the uniform implementation of collective agreements and transversal policies, ensuring that labour standards are applied equitably across the province. By facilitating proactive engagement between labour and the employer, chambers prevent disputes and minimize industrial action, directly safeguarding service delivery.

To ensure Chambers remain agile and responsive to the evolving public service landscape, the following initiatives have been launched:

Integration of provincial chambers into Council processes at national level

To better align national and provincial operations of Council, initiatives have been taken to actively bring chambers on board process at national level, where possible. By involving Chambers in national initiatives, a more integrated and effective workflow has been created.

This collaborative approach has already yielded significant results:

- **Policy Implementation:** Chambers played a vital role in implementing PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2025. They coordinated the submission of recruitment and uniform policies specific to their provinces. They also shared best practices and implementation hurdles experienced in the implementation of the said policies.
- **GEHS Support:** Working alongside the Government Employees Housing Scheme (GEHS) Working Committee, Chambers are helping identify public servants who qualify for housing allowance but are not yet receiving it.

The success of these two initiatives proves that local involvement strengthens national outcomes. We remain committed to this model and will continue to integrate Chambers into national processes whenever possible.

Strategic Planning Sessions: Provincial Coordinating Chambers

The year 2025 signified the conclusion of the Council's five-year strategic cycle, necessitating the design of a new strategy for 2026 - 2031. To ensure that the new strategy genuinely reflects the challenges and best practices across all structures of Council, the Secretariat conducted intensive strategic planning sessions for all provincial coordinating chambers between 03 June and 12 September 2025. Each engagement followed a structured three-day format:

- Phase 1: A virtual preparatory session.
- Phase 2: Two days of in-person strategic deliberations.

These sessions served as a critical diagnostic tool, capturing first-hand accounts of provincial challenges such as operational inefficiencies, resource limitations, and inter-departmental bottlenecks. Furthermore, the sessions acted as a platform for self-introspection, prompting parties to evaluate their own contributions to chamber success and propose actionable solutions for improvement.

The sessions focused on eight thematic areas essential to the future of public service labour relations:

- **Collective bargaining processes and promoting constructive dialogue and negotiation:** Identifying future priorities (wages, job security, skills) and shifting toward interest-based, collaborative negotiation.
- **Dispute resolution management:** Assessing the efficiency of conciliation and arbitration while prioritizing proactive dispute prevention.
- **Demographic shifts and workforce planning:** Addressing demographic shifts, including the aging workforce and critical skills gaps.
- **Stakeholder relations:** Rebuilding trust between the employer (government), unions, and the Council.
- **Communication and information sharing:** Enhancing transparency and the digital dissemination of information between Chambers and the Council.
- **Rules of engagement and enhancing the role of the chamber:** Reviewing rules of engagement to ensure they are fit-for-purpose and influential in shaping policy.
- **Mental health :** Institutionalizing Employee Assistance Programs (EAPs) and mental health awareness.
- **Women, youth and persons with disabilities:** Creating clear guidelines for reasonable accommodation (e.g., disability access, breastfeeding facilities) and anti-discrimination.

Key Findings

Engagements yielded the following critical insights:

- **Modernization of bargaining:** A clear call to strengthen the monitoring of agreements and upgrade negotiation skill sets.
- **Systemic consistency:** Significant gaps in grievance management require standardized procedures across all provinces.
- **Accountability:** Trust deficits remain due to the non-implementation of past resolutions; structured engagement is needed to close these gaps.
- **Wellness gaps:** There is a pervasive sentiment that current mental health support is insufficient and requires formal institutionalization.
- **Resource planning:** An urgent need for succession planning was identified to mitigate the impact of an aging public service.

The outcomes of these strategic sessions have provided the evidence base for the PSCBC Strategic Plan, focusing on institutional strengthening, enhanced accountability, and proactive labour management.

2.6 Report: Mpumalanga Labour Summit

In 2022, the Coordinating Chamber of the PSCBC for Mpumalanga Province agreed to convene a Provincial Labour Summit. The primary objectives were to:

- Define the specific obligations and responsibilities of both management and organized labour.
- Establish sustainable platforms to build a peaceful workplace environment conducive to effective service delivery.
- Identify strategies to uphold high standards of ethical conduct, discipline, and integrity.

The Summit took place on 17-18 November 2022, at Nutting House Lodge in Mbombela, the General Secretary, was invited as a guest speaker. The event concluded with the parties adopting the following resolutions:

- That all resolutions adopted by the summit must be referred to the PSCBC chamber to develop implementation strategies through the guidance of the office of the General Secretary of the PSCBC.
- To enhance labour peace in giving effect to the fundamental rights conferred in section 23 of the Constitution, the provisions of the Labour Relations Act, Basic Conditions of Employment Act, Public Service Act, Public Service Regulations and collective agreements of the PSCBC and sector councils.
- To strengthen the provincial chamber by building capacity amongst members of the chamber through agreed training and empowerment programs for specific skills development.
- To strengthen labour peace through the institution of quarterly review sessions between senior management and chief negotiators to assess performance of the chamber and to discuss relationship challenges. One of those sessions per year should be attended by the political leadership of the province and the trade unions.
- To review and appoint chief negotiators that are competent and capable to lead parties in discussions in the chamber that will result in effective resolution of matters in an expedited manner.
- To Acknowledge the right of parties to exercise their constitutional rights of picketing, striking and lock out but this must be based on collective respect for one another within the provisions and restrictions of the law.
- To restore the trust relationship through the reviewing of the performance of the Coordinating Chamber of the PSCBC for Mpumalanga Province (CCPMP) by the office of the General Secretary and providing a way forward on bettering areas of performance.
- To respect processes of collective bargaining within the CCPMP through ensuring full attendance of the meetings of the chamber by duly authorised and mandated representatives.
- To resolve items on the agenda of the CCPMP within a reasonable time and where necessary escalate undue delays to the PSCBC at national level for intervention.
- To ensure the effectiveness of the grievance procedure by concluding grievances within the 30-day period as required by the grievance rules.
- To discuss in the CCPMP the filling of vacant posts as per the PSCBC agreement on the same subject.

- Parties agree that effective discipline is imperative in correcting behaviour and ensuring proper conduct therefore they resolve to finalise disciplinary matters within 60 days as to ensure discipline is regarded as progressive.
- Special Resolution of the Summit - the establishment of a Provincial NEDLAC like structure to discuss the just renewable energy transition.

Following the endorsement of the Mpumalanga Labour Summit Declaration by the Chamber, the General Secretary spearheaded the creation of both implementation and operational plans. To ensure progress was tracked effectively, a dedicated team from the Secretariat was assembled to oversee the rollout and monitoring of these initiatives.

The implementation of the Declaration has seen significant success, over **60%** of the Declaration's objectives have already been achieved. A comprehensive skills audit for the Chamber was completed, leading to ongoing development initiatives.

Only two objectives remain outstanding. These are slated for finalization following the PSCBC Strategic Planning Session, scheduled for 3-5 March 2026.

Once the remaining objectives are fulfilled, the Chamber will convene to formally review and adopt the close-out report.

2.6.1 Intervention initiatives

Collective bargaining is a sophisticated and often high-stakes process. Given the significant interests involved, negotiations can become emotionally charged; without careful management, this volatility risks a total breakdown in communication. In instances where parties reach an impasse, the General Secretary is frequently called upon to intervene, facilitating dialogue and guiding both sides toward a mutual resolution.

Since 2020 the General Secretary has conducted the following intervention sessions:

- **CCPECP:** Revitalised dialogue following a collapse caused by the Employer's failure to submit reports.
- **CCPGP:** Assisted parties to address critical concerns regarding building conditions within the Gauteng Provincial Government.
- **CCPNCP:** Assisted parties to address issues that resulted from the transfer of the Early Childhood Development (ECD) function from the Department of Social Development to the Department of Education.

These interventions have successfully restored relations and strengthened the bargaining environment within these structures.

2.7 Training and Development

Under Clause 4.2.11 of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2022, the Council is mandated to upskill and groom new teams of negotiators to ensure future readiness. In fulfillment of this, several training programs were conducted in collaboration with PSETA and sectoral councils (GPSSBC and PHSDSBC) to empower Council members and chamber representatives.

Beyond internal training, the Council actively participates in programs and conferences hosted by key stakeholders such as SASLAW, ALLS, ILERA, and LERASA.

As a leading bargaining council in the region, the PSCBC was invited by the ILO to host a delegation from the Lesotho Public Service for a study visit. The primary objective of the visit was for the delegates to gain insight into South African labour laws and practices, specifically regarding:

- Freedom of association
- Collective bargaining
- Dispute resolution processes and challenges
- The enjoyment of political and civil rights within the public service

Building on the success of this engagement, the Council intends to undertake further study tours within the region to continue sharing expertise and gaining insights from our regional counterparts.

2.8 Conclusion

The 2020–2025 reporting period marks a definitive era of institutional maturation for the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC). Over these five years, the Collective Bargaining Unit has successfully navigated the complexities of structural realignment, shifting from a focus on basic administrative compliance to a more robust, research-driven strategy that champions the integrity of centralised collective bargaining.

The data presented in this report highlights a critical crossroads. While the Council maintains a high representivity rate of 89% of the workforce, the persistent variances between audited figures and PERSAL records, alongside the proliferation of smaller unions through "acting together" loopholes, pose a threat to the stability of social dialogue. The "integrity test" for the next strategic cycle (2026–2031) will depend on the Council's ability to centralize and authenticate membership data, ensuring that vote weight and the resulting collective agreements are beyond reproach.

Furthermore, the insights gained from the 2025 Provincial Coordinating Chamber sessions serve as a catalyst call for modernization. The shift from adversarial negotiation to interest-based, collaborative dialogue is no longer a choice but a necessity to address systemic issues such as the aging workforce, mental health gaps, and the non-implementation of resolutions.

The PSCBC remains the bedrock of labour peace in the South African public service. By enforcing signed resolutions with greater rigor, professionalizing the negotiation space through continuous training, and bridging the gap between national policy and provincial reality, the Council will not only defend centralized bargaining but actively evolve it to meet the demands of a modern, efficient, and fair public service.

The background features a complex geometric pattern of interlocking triangles in shades of gray and white. In the top-left and bottom-right corners, there are dark blue circular shapes. A network of light blue dots connected by thin lines is visible in the top-left and bottom-right areas. A central horizontal band contains a repeating geometric pattern in light purple. Overlaid on this band is a dark blue and white striped, coiled ribbon-like logo.

DISPUTE RESOLUTION

DISPUTE MANAGEMENT

Overview

The dispute resolution and prevention function is core to attaining labour peace. The Dispute Resolution Unit provides essential support to the Council towards achieving its strategic objectives.

This includes Council successfully replacing Resolution 4 of 2005, 'Rules for the conduct of proceedings before the PSCBC' with the new Rules – Resolution 1 of 2024; the implementation of the enforcement collective agreement in the public service namely, Resolution 3 of 2023; introduction of virtual hearings; two online platforms (eReferral form & PSCBC Portal); monitoring of compliance by panellist with the Service Level Agreement; and development of dispute prevention training programs to assist in the monitoring and evaluation of collective agreements in order to ensure compliance.

The report reflects on the referrals received and processes conducted by the Council from 01 April 2020 to 31 March 2025.

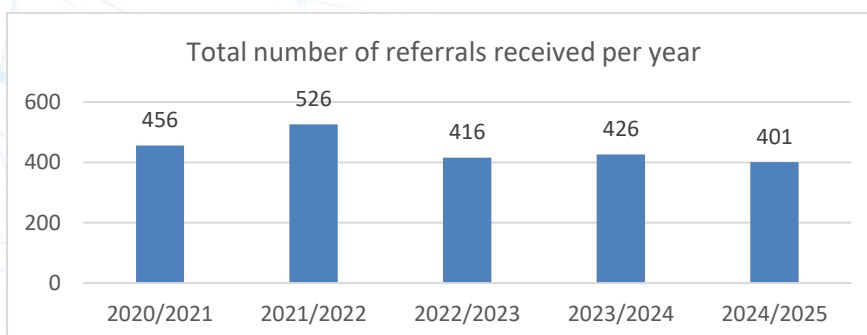
3.1 Statistics

Number of referrals received

A total number of 2225 referrals were received from 01 April 2020 to 31 March 2025.

Graph A: Annual comparison of the referrals received

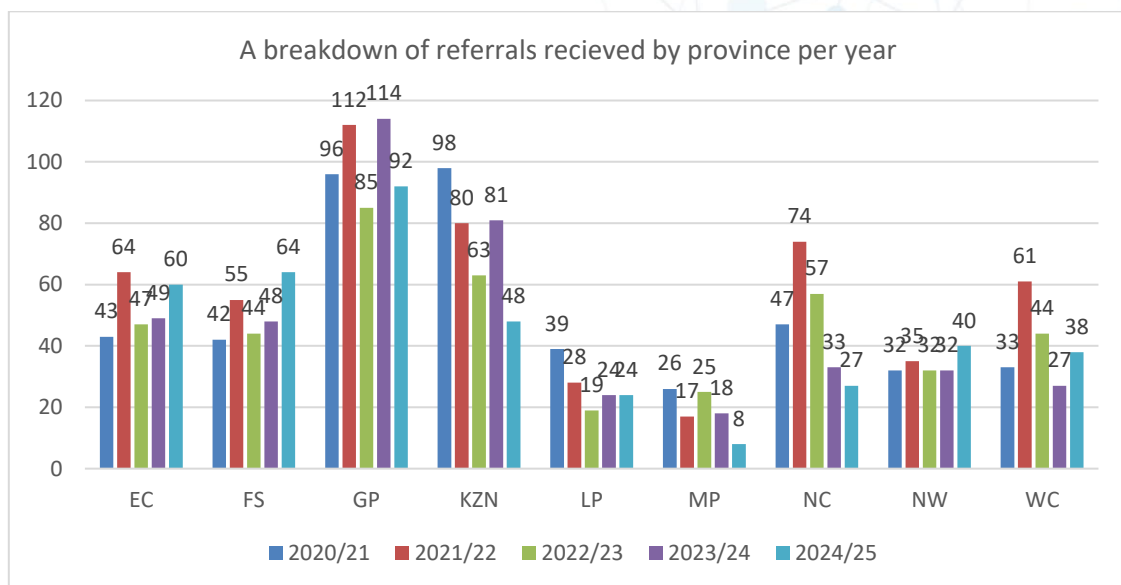
The reporting period of 2021/22 recorded the highest number of referrals followed by the reporting period 2020/21.



3.2 A breakdown of cases referred by Provinces

The Gauteng Province remains the highest referring Province with a referral rate of 22%, followed by the KwaZulu-Natal Province which referred 17% of the cases referred. Mpumalanga and Limpopo remain the least referring Provinces.

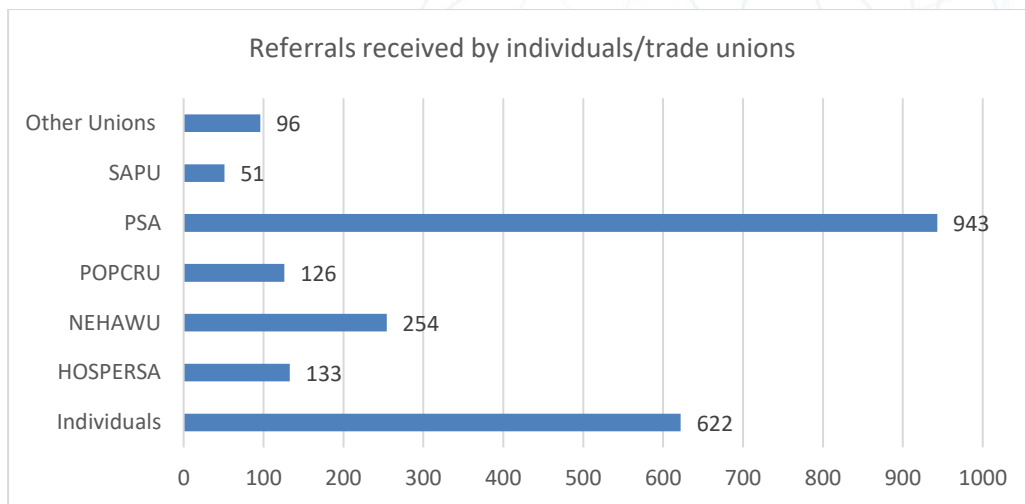
Graph B: A breakdown of referrals by Provinces



3.3 Referrals by Trade unions/individuals

The PSA referred 42% of the total referrals received in this reporting period. The disputes referred by individuals are at 28%.

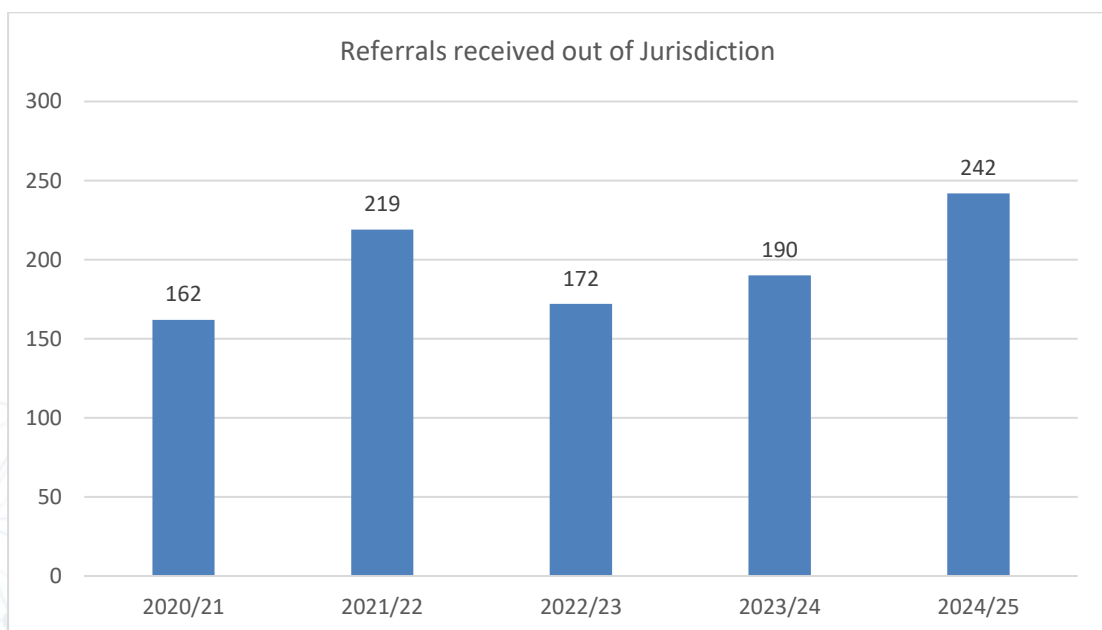
Graph C: Referrals by unions/individuals



3.4 Out of jurisdiction referred cases¹

Out of the 2225 referrals received, 44% of the referred cases were screened out of jurisdiction prior to any process.

Graph D: Out of jurisdiction



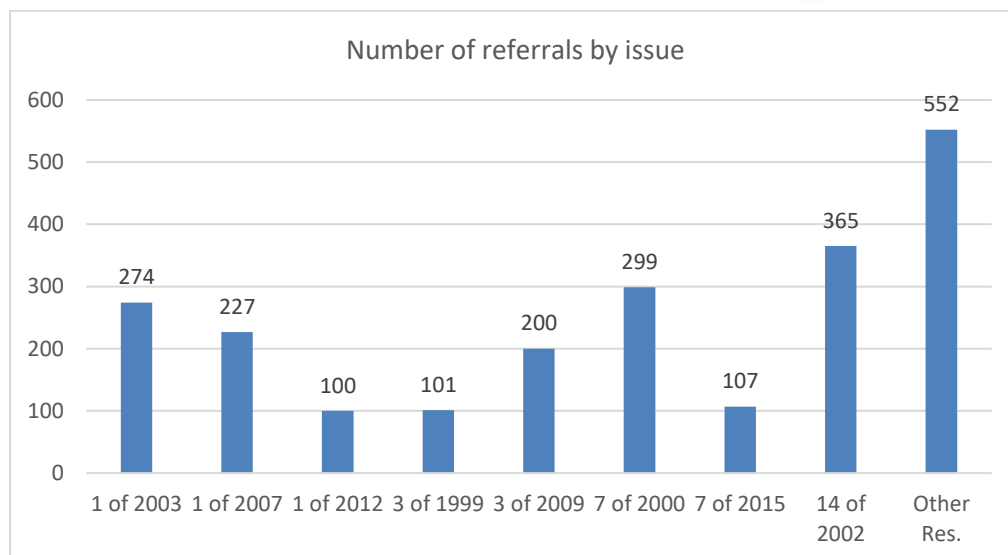
¹ Disputes relating to unfair labour practice, unfair dismissals, unilateral change to terms and conditions of employment, Sector resolutions and not properly referred, etc.

3.5 Disputes referred to conciliation by issue

The following PSCBC Resolutions are major contributors in the cases referred: -

- Disputes referred in terms of Resolution 14 of 2002² constitute 16% of the caseload.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 7 of 2000³ account for 13%.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 1 of 2003 account for 12%.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 3 of 2009⁴ read with Resolution 1 of 2012 account for 13%.

Graph E: Referrals by issue



3.6 Referrals by issue in Provinces

- Disputes relating to Resolution 1 of 2003; the disciplinary code are predominantly referred in the Gauteng, Free State and KwaZulu Natal the Provinces.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 14 of 2002; the grievance rules are predominantly referred in the Northern Cape, Gauteng and the Free State Provinces.

² Grievance rules for the Public Service

³ Improvement in the conditions of service of the Public Service employees

⁴ Revised salary structure for employees on salary levels 1-12 not covered by OSD

- Disputes relating to Resolution 7 of 2000; conditions of service are received mainly in the Kwa-Zulu Natal, Western Cape, and Gauteng Provinces.

Table A: A breakdown of referrals by Issue in Provinces

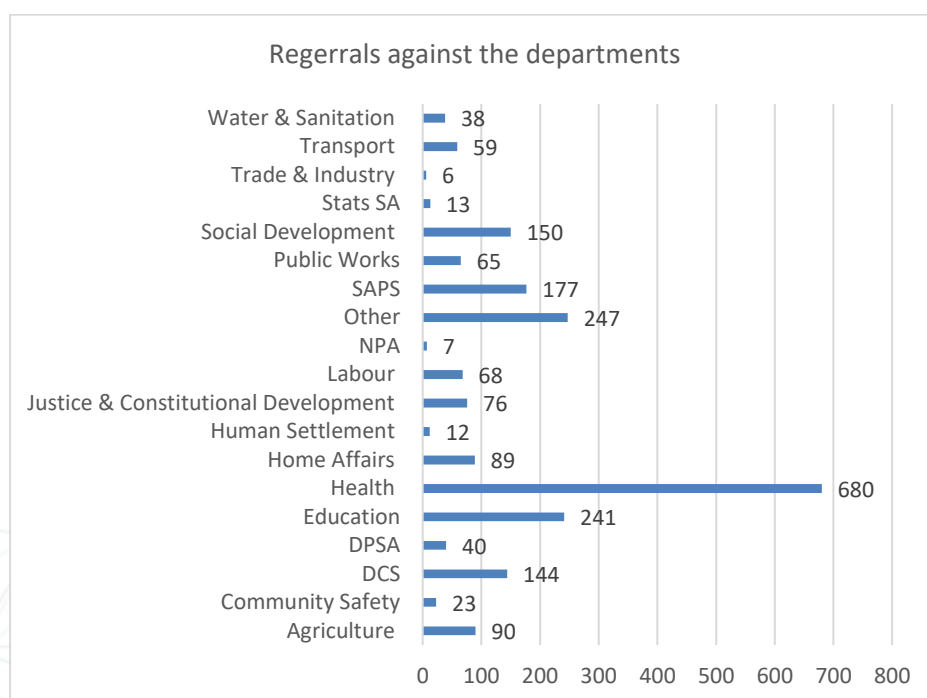
Issue	EC	FS	GP	KZN	LP	MP	NC	NW	WC	Total
Res 1 of 2003	28	32	104	29	24	6	10	26	15	274
Res 1 of 2007	26	23	39	48	16	9	25	16	25	227
Res 1 of 2012	20	7	20	15	4	5	17	5	7	100
Res 3 of 1999	15	7	14	18	10	8	17	5	7	101
Res 3 of 2009	19	9	44	69	9	10	16	16	8	200
Res 7 of 2000	46	33	47	58	8	6	30	17	54	299
Res 7 of 2015	17	13	18	18	3	7	7	9	15	107

Res 14 of 2002	23	62	72	45	10	15	110	21	7	365
Other	58	69	138	87	35	27	47	54	37	552
Total	252	255	496	387	119	93	279	169	175	2225

3.7 Referrals against the Departments

In relation to the referrals within the Departments, the Department of Health continues to be the highest referred against.

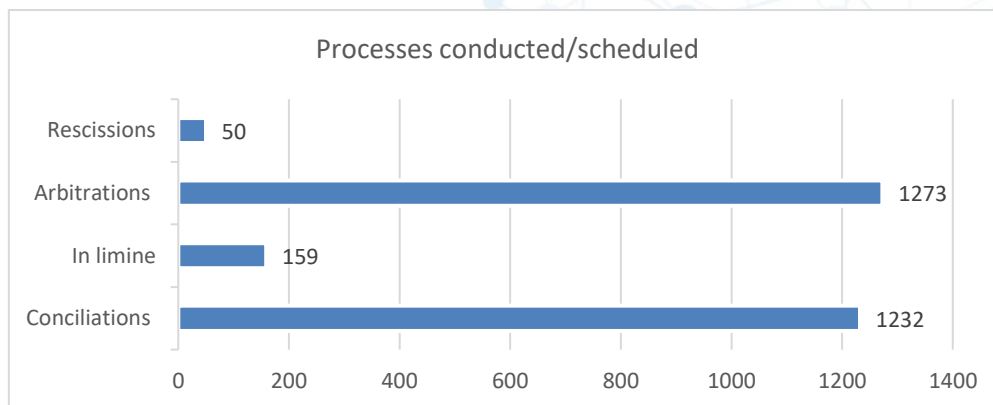
Graph F: Referrals against the Departments



3.8 Processes conducted/scheduled

A total number of 2714. These processes include 159 in limine⁵, 50 rescissions in terms of Section 144 of the LRA, 1232 conciliations, and 1273 arbitrations.

Graph G: A breakdown of processes conducted



3.9 Arbitration outcomes

The Council conducted 1273 arbitrations, 263 arbitrations awards were rendered, 421 postponements, 179 withdrawals, 53 dismissals and 120 settlements.

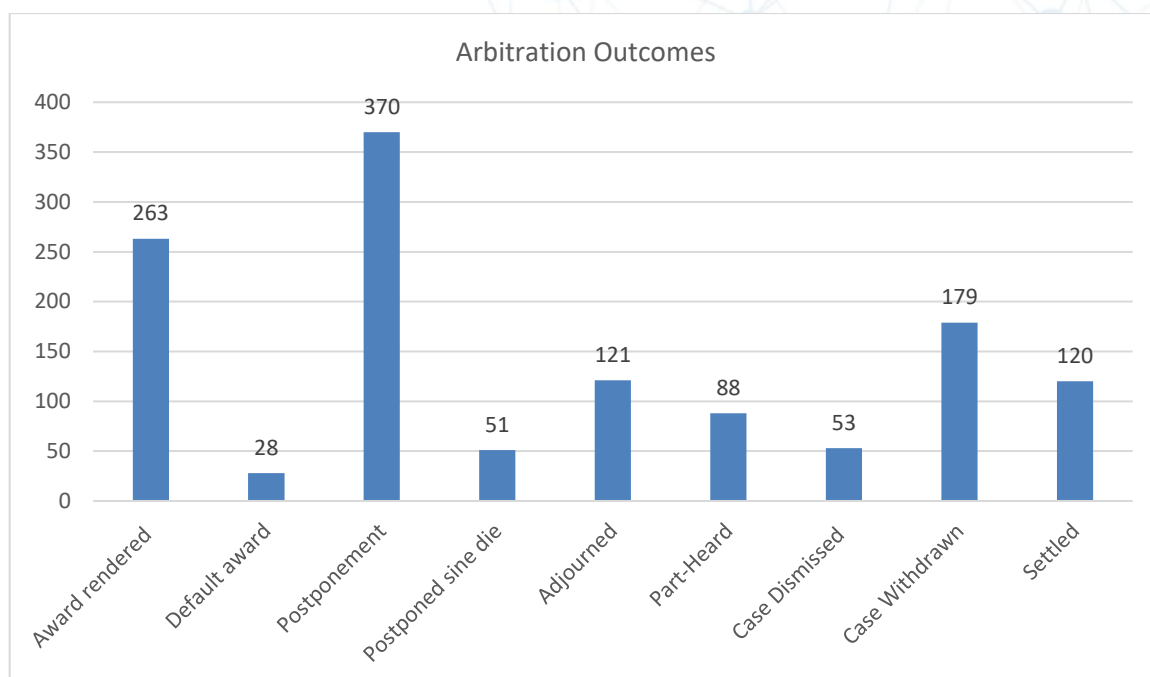
It is to be noted that 14% of the disputes were withdrawn at arbitration level. The stats indicate an 33% rate of postponement. The reasons for postponements occasioned by parties and panellists range from the following:

- Limited or poor connectivity on virtual platforms.
- Postponed sine die pending further submissions of documents and investigation.
- By agreement between the parties – no reasons advanced.
- Parties to attempt settlement.
- Postponed pending discussions between the parties.

⁵ A hearing on a specific legal point, which takes place before the actual case referred, can be heard

The pre-arbitration process as envisaged in the DR Procedure is barely used by the parties⁶. A very low usage of less than 1% has been recorded.

Graph H: The graph below illustrates the outcomes of the arbitrations scheduled/conducted

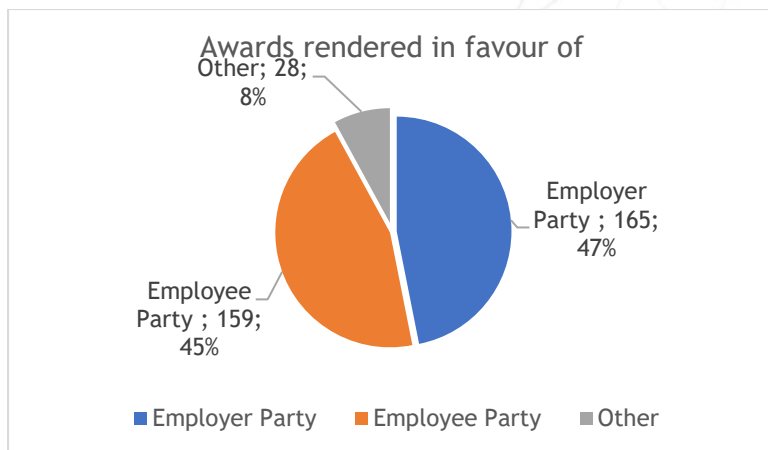


3.10 Arbitration awards in favour of employee, employer and out of jurisdiction

A total of 352 arbitration awards were rendered period regardless of when the arbitration was finalized. 159 were found in favour of the unions/ employees, which represent 45% of the award rendered and 165 awards in favour of the employer which makes up 47% of the awards rendered. Other, 28 awards which were neither in favour of employee nor the employer which ruled that Council does not have jurisdiction make up 8% of the awards rendered.

Graph I: A breakdown of arbitration award in favour of

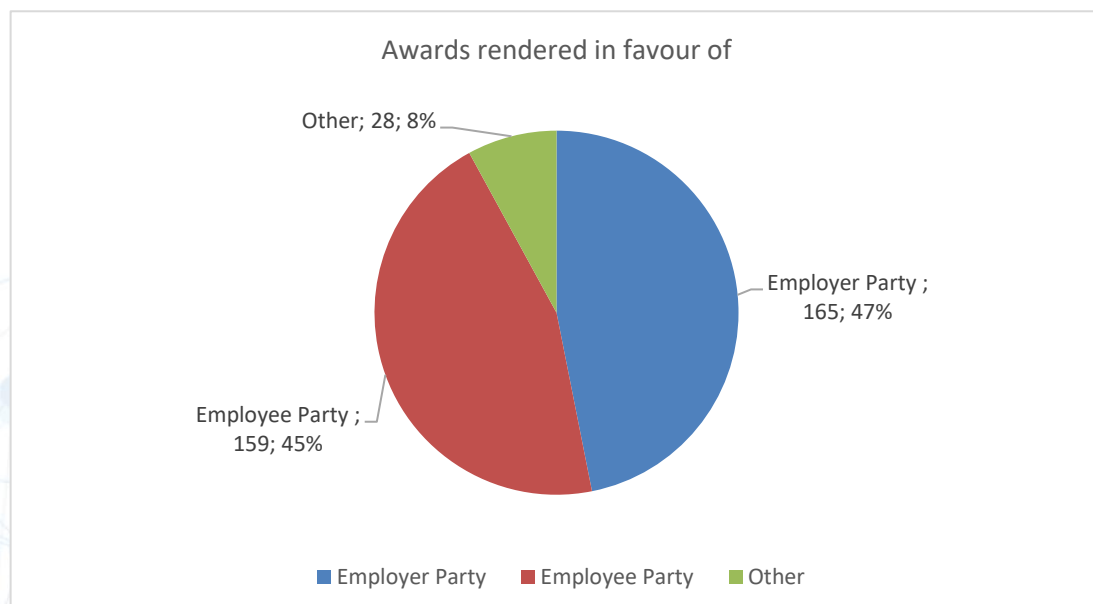
⁶ Clause 5.4 of the PSCBC DR Procedure

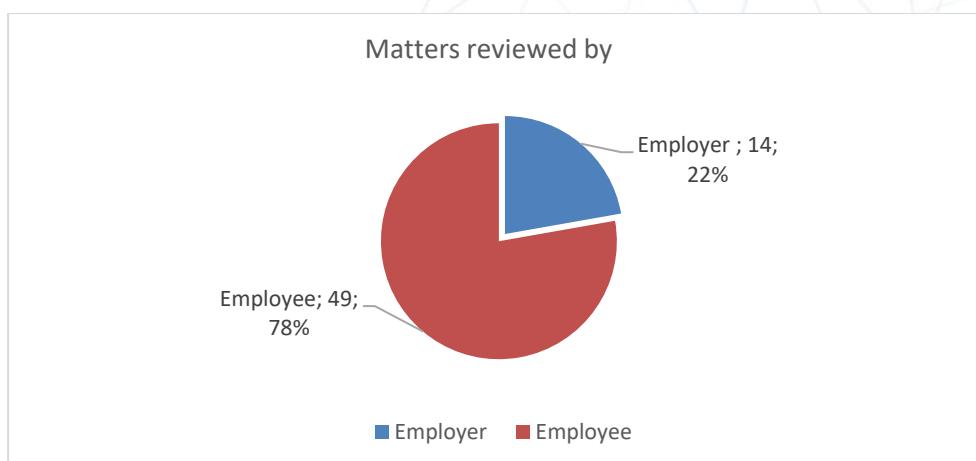


3.11 Cases on review

A total of 63 cases have been taken on review in this reporting period. The statistics indicate that the employee party has taken on review 78% of the awards and the employer party 22% of awards to the Labour Court.

Graph J: A breakdown of party reviewing matters at the Labour Court in terms of Section 145 of the LRA





3.12 Training and development and capacity building

Stakeholders

The PSCBC is dedicated to efficient dispute resolution within the public service. This is achieved by building stakeholder capacity through workshops and continuously improving our processes to align with evolving labour relations practices and public service needs.

The PSCBC undertook to conduct national and provincial workshops in March to May 2024. Eleven workshops were conducted. These workshops covered all nine provinces with two additional national workshops. The purpose of the workshops was to capacitate and create awareness on the recently signed Resolutions pertaining to dispute resolution and the digitalized processes.

The workshops were held as follows –

Table B: A breakdown of the different workshops held – 2024

National/Province	Venue	Date	No. of Attendees
Gauteng, Johannesburg	Gold Reef City	13 March 2024	38
National Departments, Pretoria	Time Square, Menlyn	27 March 2024	65
Mpumalanga, Nelspruit	Emnotweni, The Arena	10 April 2024	74
Limpopo, Polokwane	Park Inn by Radisson	15 April 2024	75
Eastern Cape, East London	ICC - Premier Hotel	22 April 2024	83
National Departments, Pretoria	Time Square, Menlyn	24 April 2024	68
Western Cape, Cape Town	The Cape Sun	06 May 2024	79

North West, Rustenburg	ANEW Resort Hunters Rest	08 May 2024	82
Northern Cape, Kimberley	Protea Hotel, Kimberley	15 May 2024	66
Free State, Bloemfontein	Bon Hotel	16 May 2024	60
Kwa-Zulu Natal, Durban	Premier Inn, Umhlanga	20 May 2024	77

3.13 PSCBC Online Platforms

The Council has in this period successfully launched two online platforms - the Portal to Parties and the e-Referral form to enhance access to the Council's dispute resolution processes and to align with technological advancements. The PSCBC Portal is an advancement to the Council's automated business management systems. The Portal extends to functions which allow panellists and parties to connect to the internal business management system and interact with processes in real-time.

- Portal to Parties activated in July 2024. This Portal is exclusively available to the parties to Council, (trade unions who are parties to Council and the State as the employer).
- The e-Referral platform introduced in April 2024. This form is available to all to refer matters.

While the online e-referral system is accessible to all users, parties to Council are encouraged to register on the Portal to benefit from its additional exclusive features.

3.14 Legal consulting services

The PSCBC appointed legal services for the matters below as referred to the PSCBC for conciliation and arbitration in the reporting period.

- Edward Nathan Sonnerbergs: Skulpad & 1 other // DOH
- Fasken: Seetse & 1 other // DALLRD
- Fasken: Sibisi & Another // DHA

3.15 Panellists/Commissioners

The Council, Sector Council and other Bargaining Councils utilize services of independent services providers to conduct conciliations and arbitrations. This pool is drawn from the CCMA accredited panel of conciliators and mediators. Further, the pool of conciliators and arbitrators is shared amongst all the

statutory Bargaining Council and CCMA accredited agencies. Council has further to that appointed two Resident Panellists who deal with all conciliations to ensure all conciliations are handled within the statutory 30-day period.

Table C PSCBC: List of part-time panellists

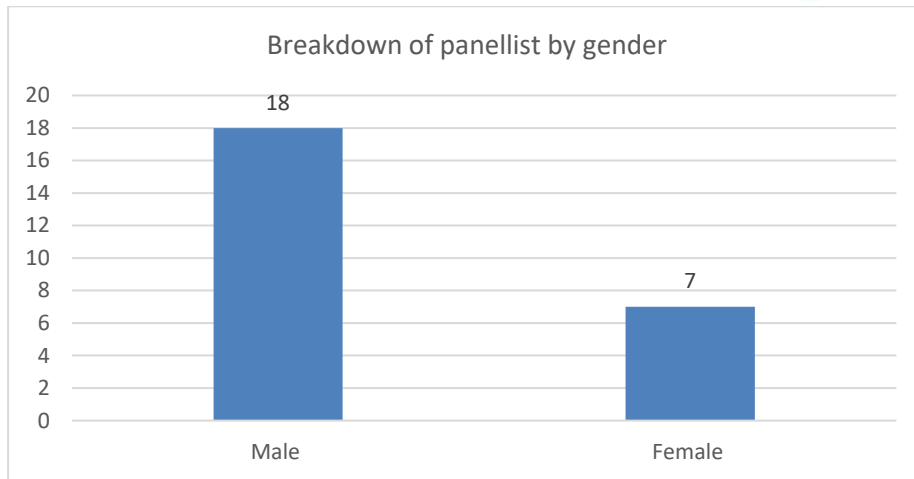
No.	Surname	Name	Gender	Race
1.	Bevan	Annelie	Female	White
2.	De Vlieger - Seynhave	Ilse	Female	White
3.	Fouché	Marion	Female	White
4.	Goldman	Bella	Female	White
5.	Gruss	Jonathan	Male	Coloured
6.	Hanekom	Jurgens Phillip	Male	White
7.	Howitz	Michael	Male	White
8.	Jazbhay	Saber	Male	Indian
9.	Kayster	Isaac Kelvin Bennedict	Male	Coloured
10.	Kleinot	Karen Deborah	Female	White
11.	Mashigo	Tshepo	Male	Black
12.	Mkhize	Nkosinathi	Male	Black
13.	Mofsowitz	Hilary	Female	White
14.	Nagdee	Yusuf	Male	Indian
15.	Ngcengeni	Vuyiso	Male	Black
16.	Ntimbana	Thomas	Male	Black
17.	Olivier	Retief	Male	White
18.	Osman	Shiraz Mahomed	Male	Indian
19.	Phala	Magate	Male	Black
20.	Pietersen	David	Male	Coloured

21.	Pretorius	Richard William	Male	White
22.	Randall	Clarence	Male	Coloured
23.	Robertson	John	Male	White
24.	Thee	Joseph Wilson	Male	Coloured
25.	Van der Merwe	Minette	Female	White

Out of the panel of 25 panellists, only 11 panellists are currently active (providing dates).

Graph K: A breakdown of panellist by gender

The pool of arbitrators consists of only 7 female panellists. Noting that only 3 are active.



3.16 CCMA Set Targets/Efficiencies

The CCMA sets out the efficiencies or targets that the Bargaining Councils need to meet in order to ensure it's optimal performance. A table below weightings sets out a formula with the statutory requirements and other key performance areas:-

EFFICIENCY/MINIMUM REQUIREMENT	Approved	Weighting	Notes
Telephonic/Pre-conciliations heard of jurisdictional cases	10%	3.75%	Hear 10% or more of all jurisdictional referrals using the pre-conciliation process
Pre-conciliations settled of jurisdictional cases	7%	3.75%	Settle 7% or more of all jurisdictional referrals using the pre-conciliation process
Conciliations heard outside 30 days	0%	20%	0% Statutory requirement
Conciliations heard & closed	90%	3.75%	Close 90% or more of all conciliations heard (includes all 'con-arb', conciliation and telephonic conciliation type processes)
Con/arbs scheduled & finalised	50%	15%	Finalise 50% or more of con/arb cases in a single event. Includes 'settled' and 'awards rendered'
Settlement rate	40-49%	15%	Settle 40% to 49% or more cases across all processes
Arbitrations finalized (of cases heard)	90%	3.75%	Finalise 90% of arbitration heard
Late Awards	0%	20%	0% Statutory requirement
Adjournments/Part Heard (of events heard)	10%	3.75%	Allow for the maximum of 10% adjournment of all processes scheduled
Postponements/adjournments (of events heard)	10%	3.75%	Allow for the maximum of 10% postponement of all processes scheduled
Turnaround times conciliation (days)	30	3.75%	Conciliation process to take place from 'activation' to 'closed' within a maximum of 30 days
Turnaround times arbitration (days)	120	3.75%	Arbitration process to take place from arb referral date to 'closed' within a maximum of 120 days

A concern was raised with the CCMA in relation to the set efficiencies. Not all Bargaining Councils are able to meet the above criteria due to the reasons stated above. The Public Service Bargaining Councils have been requested to conduct extensive research and submit a report to the CCMA outlining the challenges facing the Public Service Bargaining Councils. The report has been submitted to the CCMA and feedback is awaited.

CCMA Limitations

The challenges faced by the Bargaining Councils in attaining the required CCMA efficiencies and the lack of panellists' availability were brought to the attention of the CCMA.

The CCMA indicated that it preferred that the Bargaining Councils recruit and utilize CCMA accredited panellists, irrespective of the type of the dispute the Bargaining Council decided to utilize these panellists.

The CCMA pointed out that it had embarked on an extensive recruitment process to expand its panel of conciliators and arbitrators. The panel should reasonably be sufficient to meet the needs of the CCMA, accredited agencies and the affected Bargaining Councils.

Review of panellist fee structure

Following the adopted panellist daily fees review, below is a breakdown of the new fees payable per day. Due to Council's decision to hold all hearings virtually, a data fee allowance has been implemented for that purpose.

DESCRIPTION	OLD FEE	NEW FEE
Daily Fee	R 2 500.00	R 3 000.00
Data Fee (new)	-	R 50.00 - R300.00
Travel Fee Rate	R 3.50	R 4.50

The above was implemented effective from 01 May 2025.

3.17 Conclusion

- Efforts are underway to further educate and re-train parties on the use and benefits of the PSCBC Portal. While the parties are gradually gaining confidence in the introduced online platforms, interaction numbers remain relatively low.
- The Council is aware of the high rate of referrals that fall outside its jurisdiction, primarily due to a lack of understanding regarding the roles of the PSCBC and the sector councils. To address this issue, initiatives focused on educating employees and referring parties are crucial, particularly concerning the categorization of disputes.
- It is essential to develop a comprehensive training program that encompasses both theoretical knowledge and practical skills, incorporating case studies and role-playing exercises.
- The Council is committed to launching vigorous initiatives to educate parties and provide clear guidelines on the types of disputes that fall under the jurisdiction of the PSCBC and the sector councils.
- It is important to note that referrals from individual employees are high, and an increasing number of employees are opting for legal representation rather than trade union representation.
- The settlement rate remains low, despite the CCMA efficiency requirement to achieve a 40-49% settlement rate. The CCMA is aware of this challenge, given the public sector environment but failure to meet this requirement could affect the Council's accreditation.
- The Council in partnership with other sector councils is committed to launching a training programme to educate its parties on issues related to 'mandate to settle' and how to enter into a settlement agreement in an attempt to improve the settlement rate across the public sector.

The background features a complex geometric pattern of white and light gray polygons on a dark blue field. Overlaid on this are two network diagrams: one in the top left and one in the bottom right, both consisting of blue nodes connected by thin lines. A central horizontal band has a green and white geometric pattern.

RESIDENT PANELIST



PSCBC RESIDENT PANELLIST UNIT OPERATIONAL REPORT

4. Overview

Dispute resolution and prevention are core functions to attaining labour peace. The Resident Panellist Unit provides essential support to the Council towards achieving its strategic objectives, which include the conducting of conciliations and arbitrations, handling of applications submitted to the Council, and quality assuring of rulings and awards submitted by external panellists.

This report reflects on the processes conducted by the Resident Panellists from 01 April 2020 – 31 March 2025.

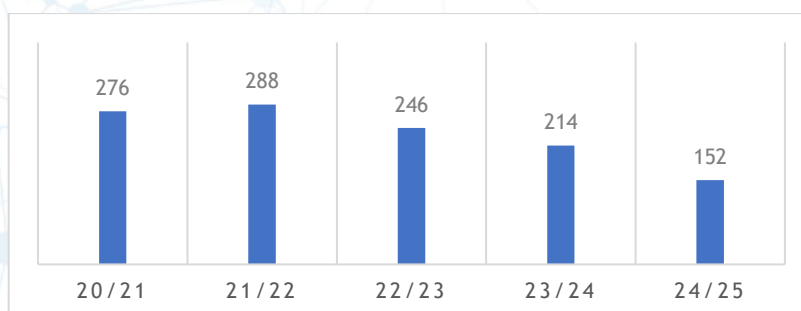
It should be noted that the cases referred to in this report and the subsequent statistics are solely based on the processes that sat before the Resident Panellists, meaning that, for example, if a case was withdrawn before the hearing date it would not form part of this report. Therefore, the number of processes conducted in this report and the number of processes conducted and outcomes in the Dispute Resolution Unit's report will not always be similar.

4.1 Statistics

4.1.1 Number of Conciliations and *In Limine* Processes Conducted

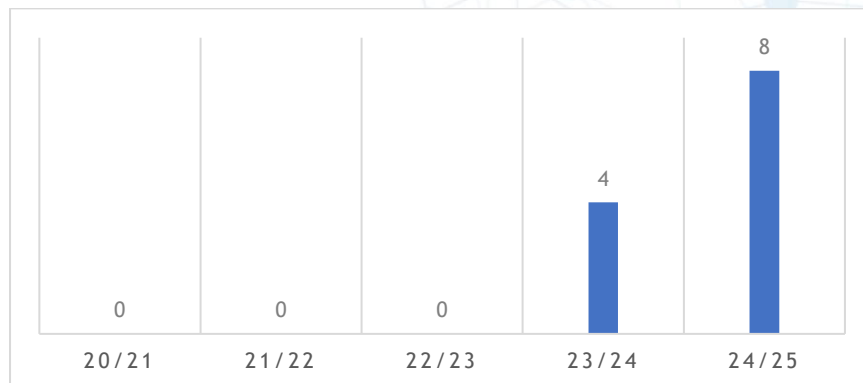
A total number of 1 176 conciliations - of which 12 were *in limine* processes - were set down and conducted by the Resident Panellist Unit from 01 April 2020 to 31 March 2025.

Graph One: Comparison of the number of conciliations conducted



The reporting period of 2021/2022 recorded the highest number of conciliations, followed by the reporting period 2020/2021. There has been a steady decrease in the number of conciliations conducted during the period 2020–2025, primarily due to a decline in the number of matters referred to the Council.

Graph Two: Comparison of the number of *in limine* processes conducted



There were a total of 12 *in limine* processes - where jurisdictional points were raised during the hearing - conducted between 01 April 2020 and 31 March 2025. The reporting period of 2024/2025 recorded the highest number of *in limine* processes. The sharp increase in jurisdictional points raised at conciliation is largely attributable to the Labour Appeal Court judgment in *Health and Other Services Personnel Trade Union of SA obo Tshambi v Department of Health, KwaZulu-Natal* (2016) 37 ILJ 1839 (LAC). The Court confirmed that jurisdiction depends on the true nature of the dispute and compliance with the applicable statutory time frames, rather than the manner in which the dispute is labelled. The subsequent workshops, conducted by the Council, played a significant role in informing and capacitating parties on the implications of this judgment, contributing to the increased frequency of jurisdictional points being raised at conciliation.

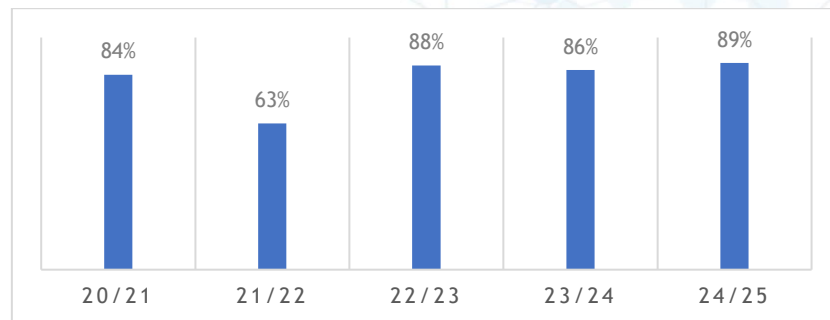
4.1.2 Nature of Dispute

Between 01 April 2020 and 31 March 2025 all the conciliations that were conducted by the Resident Panellist Unit were interpretation and/or application disputes.

4.1.3 Cases Attended by Representatives of Unions

Attendance by applicant representatives has generally remained within the 80–90% range. The notable exception is the 2021/22 period, during which attendance levels declined to 63%.

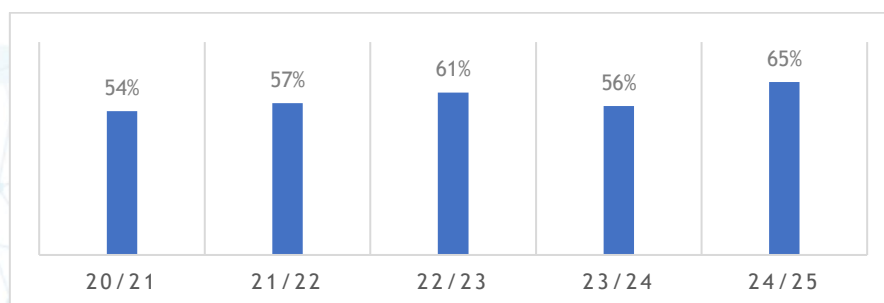
Graph Three: A comparison of attendance of representatives of the Applicant



4.1.4. Cases Attended by Representatives of Departments

Attendance by departmental representatives has ranged between 50–65%, which is comparatively low and a cause for concern, as it undermines the potential for meaningful engagement and effective dispute resolution during conciliation proceedings.

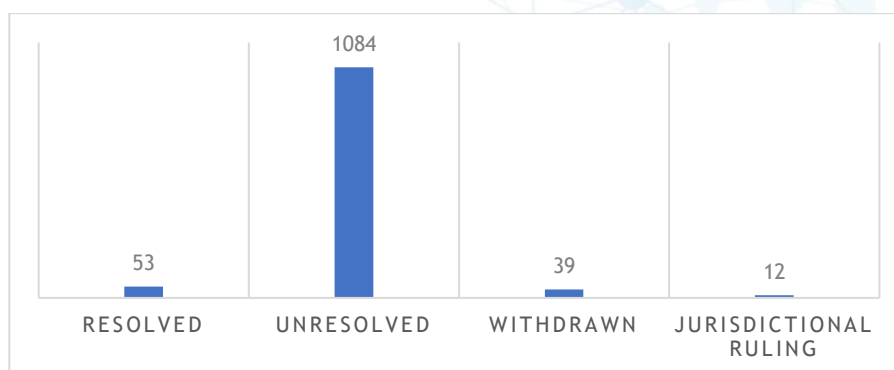
Graph Four: A comparison of attendance of representatives of Departments



4.1.5. Outcomes of the Conciliations Conducted

The graph below shows the outcomes of the conciliations that have been conducted by the Resident Panellist Unit.

Graph Five: Outcomes of the conciliations conducted



Unfortunately, there is still mistrust between parties. In some cases, there are settlements between parties, but the applicant will opt to receive a certificate stating that the matter remains unresolved. This affords the applicant the opportunity to refer the matter to arbitration in the event of the respondent not complying with the proposed settlement.

4.1.6. Costs of Conducting Conciliations & *In Limine* processes

Below is a breakdown of the costs of conducting conciliations processes from 01 April 2020 to 31 March 2025 totaling R 71 166.94. The table below also indicates the estimated costs for the reporting period if the conciliations were to be done by our external panel of commissioners. It also indicates the estimated savings, R 2 102 583.06, that have been made because the conciliations were done by the Resident Panellist Unit.

Table A: A breakdown of the costs of conducting conciliations

NUMBER OF CASES	COST PER CASE	ESTIMATED COST*	ACTUAL COST^	ESTIMATED SAVINGS
2020/21 – 276	R 1 850.00	R 510 600.00	R 16 716.66	R 493 883.34
2021/22 – 288	R 1 850.00	R 532 800.00	R 17 443.47	R 515 356.53
2022/23 – 245	R 1 850.00	R 453 250.00	R 14 839.06	R 438 410.94
2023/24 – 214	R 1 850.00	R 395 900.00	R 12 961.47	R 382 938.53
2024/25 – 152	R 1 850.00	R 281 200.00	R 9 206.28	R 271 993.72
TOTAL	-	R 2 173 750.00	R 71 166.94	R 2 102 583.06

* Estimated cost: Number of cases x cost per case.

^ Actual cost: Amount of conciliations / Working hours in reporting period x Salaries for Panellists for the reporting.

Below is a breakdown of the costs of conducting *in limine* processes from 01 April 2020 to 31 March 2025 totaling R 787.38. The table below also indicates the estimated costs for the reporting period if the *in limine* processes were to be done by our external panel of commissioners. It also indicates the estimated savings, R 11 762.62, that have been made because these processes were done by the Resident Panellist Unit.

Table B: A breakdown of the costs of conducting *in limine* processes

NUMBER OF CASES	COST PER CASE	DOCUMENT FEE	ESTIMATED COST*	ACTUAL COST^	ESTIMATED SAVINGS
2020/21 – 0	-	-	-	-	-
2021/22 – 0	-	-	-	-	-
2022/23 – 1	R 1 850.00	(1 x 500) R 500.00	R 2 350.00	R 60.57	R 2 289.43
2023/24 – 4	R 1 850.00	(4 x 500) R 2 000.00	R 9 400.00	R 242.27	R 9 157.73
2024/25 – 8	R 1 850.00	(8 x 500) R 4 000.00	R 9 206.28	R 271 993.72	R 271 993.72
TOTAL	-	R 7 000.00	R 12 550.00	R 787.38	R 11 762.62

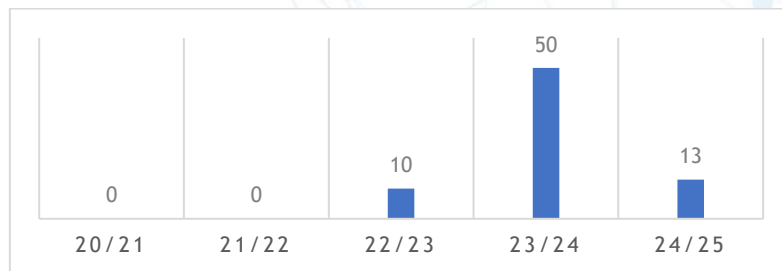
* Estimated cost: Number of cases x cost per case + document fee.

^ Actual cost: Amount of conciliations / Working hours in reporting period x Salaries for Panellists for the reporting.

4.1.7. Number of Arbitrations Conducted

A total number of 73 arbitrations were conducted, by the Resident Panellist Unit, from 01 April 2020 to 31 March 2025. However, it is important to note that the unit was only formally assigned this function from the 2022/2023 period onwards, which should be taken into account when interpreting the data for earlier periods.

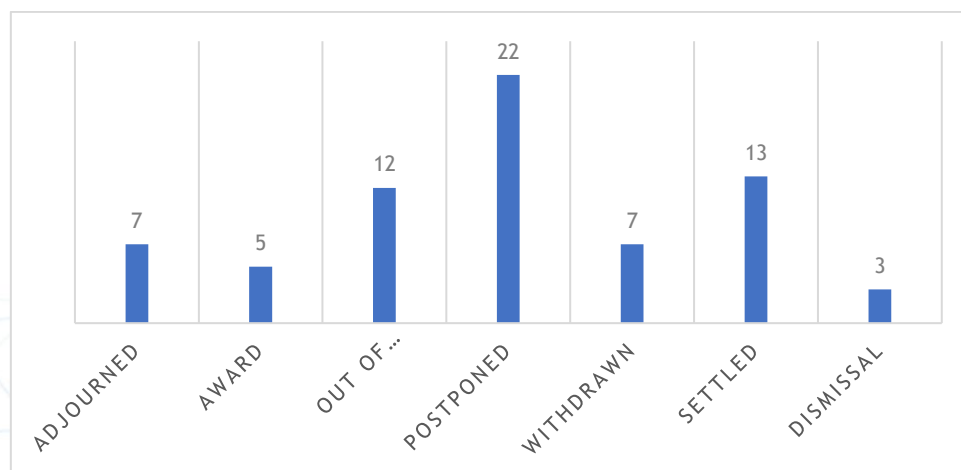
Graph Six: Comparison of the number of arbitrations conducted



The decline in the number of cases between the 2023/24 and 2024/25 periods is largely attributable to the Council's decision to no longer deal with disputes arising from Resolution 14 of 2002, which, in terms of the resolution, should be referred to the Public Service Commission. Disputes relating to Resolution 14 of 2002 constituted the majority of arbitrations conducted during the 2023/24 period.

The following are the outcomes for the arbitrations conducted by the Resident Panellist Unit:

Graph Seven: Outcomes of arbitrations conducted



4.1.8. Costs of Conducting Arbitrations

Below is a breakdown of the costs of conducting arbitrations from 01 April 2020 to 31 March 2025 totaling R 35 371.48. The table below also indicates the estimated costs for the reporting

period if the arbitrations were to be done by our external panel of commissioners. It also indicates the estimated savings, R 257 628.52, that have been made because these processes were done by the Resident Panellist Unit.

Table C: A breakdown of the costs of conducting arbitrations

NUMBER OF CASES	DOCUMENT FEE	DAILY FEE	ESTIMATED COST*	ACTUAL COST^	ESTIMATED SAVINGS
Adjournment Ruling – 7	(7 x 500.00) R 3 500.00	(7 x 500.00) R 3 500.00	R 28 000.00	R 3 391.79	R 24 608.21
Award – 9	9 x 1 000.00) R 9 000.00	(9 x 3 500.00) R 31 500.00	R 40 500.00	R 4 360.87	R 36 139.13
Dismissal – 3	(3 x 500.00) R 1 500.00	(3 x 3 500.00) R 10 500.00	R 12 000.00	R 1 453.62	R 10 546.38
Jurisdictional Ruling – 12	(12 x 500.00) R 6 000.00	(12 x 3 500.00) R 42 000.00	R 48 000.00	R 5 814.49	R 42 185.51
Postponment – 22	(22 x 500.00) R 11 000.00	(22 x 3 500.00) R 77 000.00	R 88 000.00	R 10 659.90	R 77 340.10
Settled – 13	(13 x 500.00) R 6 500.00	(13 x 3 500.00) R 45 500.00	R 52 000.00	R 6 299.03	R 45 700.97
Withdrawals – 7	-	(7 x 3 500.00) R 24 500.00	R 24 500.00	R 3 391.79	R 21 108.21
			R 293 000.00	R 35 371.48	R 257 628.52

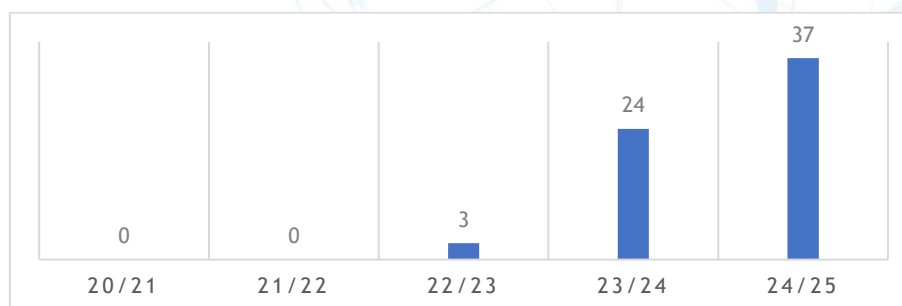
* Estimated cost: (Number of cases x document fee) + (number of cases x daily fee)

^ Actual cost: Number of cases x estimated hours the Panellist would have spent / Working hours in reporting period x Salaries of Resident Panellists during reporting period.

4.1.9. Applications

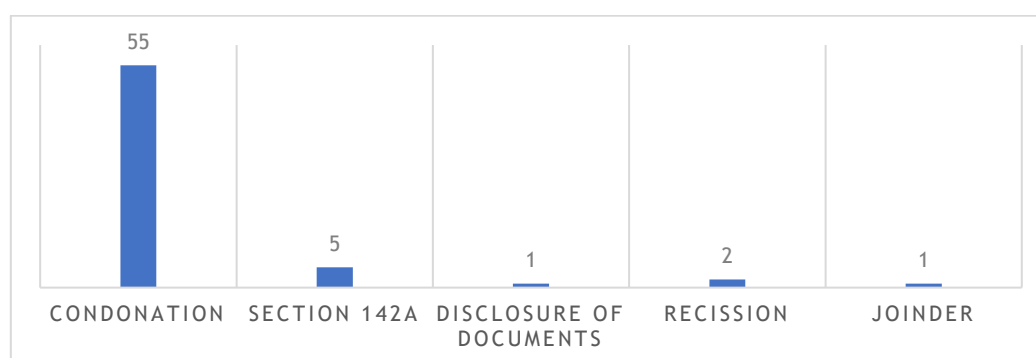
The Resident Panellist Unit is tasked with dealing with some of the applications received by the Council. These applications include condonation applications, S142A applications and rescission applications, to name a few. During the current reporting period a total of 59 applications were received and rulings were issued. However, it is important to note that the unit was only formally assigned this function from the 2022/2023 period onwards, which should be taken into account when interpreting the data for earlier periods.

Graph Eight: Number of applications dealt with by the Resident Panelist Unit



The following are the types of applications received by the Resident Panellist Unit:

Graph Nine: Types of applications dealt with by the Resident Panellist Unit

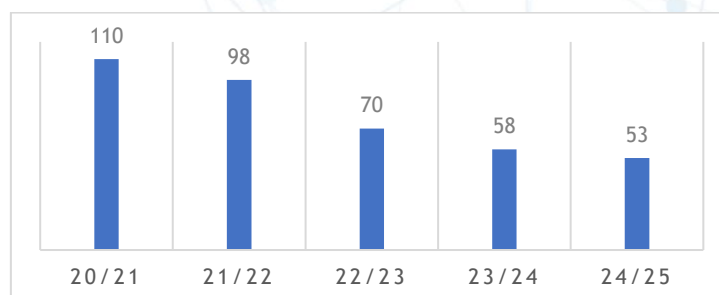


4.1.10. Quality Control

All the awards and rulings that are issued by the Council's panel of commissioners go through a strict quality assurance process as part of said process the Resident Panellist Unit is tasked with perusing awards and rulings.

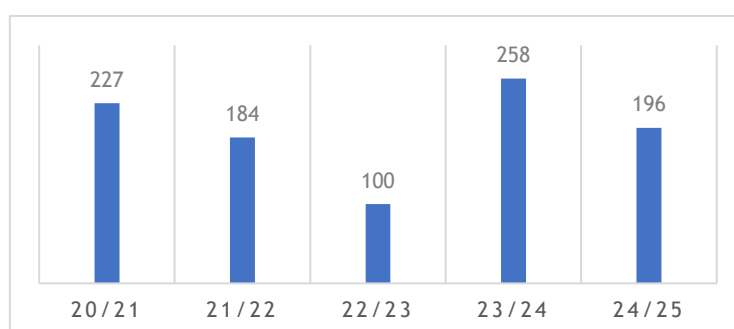
A total number of 389 awards were perused in the period 01 April 2020 to 31 March 2025. There has been a steady decrease in the number of awards perused, primarily as a result of the decline in cases referred to the Council. This has, in turn, led to fewer arbitrations being conducted and consequently a reduced number of arbitration awards requiring perusal.

Graph Ten: Number of Awards Perused



A total number of 965 rulings were perused in the period 01 April 2020 to 31 March 2025. There have been fluctuations in the number of rulings perused over the 2020 – 2025 period, with a notable decrease recorded during the 2022/23 period.

Graph Eleven: Number of Rulings Perused



4.2. Challenges

4.2.1. Impact of COVID-19 and the Shift in Conciliation Modalities

The COVID-19 pandemic necessitated an abrupt shift from in-person conciliations to teleconciliations. This transition was accompanied by poor attendance, particularly on the part of respondent representatives, as well as limited meaningful engagement during proceedings. The telephonic format often undermined the perceived seriousness of the process, negatively affecting participation levels and the effectiveness of conciliation.

Intervention:

In response, the Council transitioned from tele-conciliations to fully virtual conciliations conducted via online platforms. This shift enhanced the legitimacy and formality of the conciliation process, leading to improved attendance by both applicants and respondents. The visual and interactive nature of virtual proceedings contributed to greater engagement and more constructive dispute resolution outcomes.

4.2.2. Decline in Case Referrals and Workload Reconfiguration

A sustained decrease in the number of cases referred to the Council resulted in a corresponding decline in the number of conciliations and arbitrations conducted, thereby reducing the traditional dispute resolution workload of the unit.

Intervention:

Despite the reduction in core dispute volumes, the unit's functions were expanded to include the processing of applications, thereby partially offsetting the decrease in conciliations and arbitrations. In addition, the unit undertook several strategic and developmental initiatives, including joint projects such as the review of the Dispute Resolution Rules, the development of enforcement processes, the drafting of Picketing Rules, and participation in Dispute Management Committee meetings. Capacity-building and stakeholder engagement initiatives were also prioritised through case law webinars, workshops, and the dissemination of case law summary videos via social media platforms.

4.2.3. Jurisdictional Approach by Sectoral Bargaining Councils

When disputes are referred to Sectoral Bargaining Councils in circumstances where the subject matter is regulated by a PSCBC resolution, such disputes are often determined to be out of jurisdiction without a substantive assessment of the dispute. This approach frequently results in insufficient consideration of the true nature of the dispute and whether jurisdiction may, in fact, lie

with the PSCBC. This often results in applicants being referred from one bargaining council to another, causing delays and uncertainty in the resolution of disputes. Even where the PSCBC ultimately hears the matter, the limitations inherent in an interpretation and/or application dispute frequently restrict the scope of the relief that may be granted. As a result, applicants may not obtain a remedy that substantively addresses or fully resolves the underlying dispute.

Intervention:

There is a need for greater emphasis on the proper characterisation of disputes, in line with established jurisprudence, which requires an assessment of the true issue in dispute rather than a mechanical reliance on the existence of a PSCBC resolution. Enhanced guidance, training, and alignment between councils would assist in ensuring that jurisdictional determinations are made following a thorough analysis of the dispute, thereby reducing premature dismissals and unnecessary referrals.

4.3 Achievements

It should be noted that a number of the achievements outlined below were realised through joint projects undertaken in collaboration with the Dispute Resolution Unit and other internal stakeholders.

4.3.1. Introduction of Alternative Conciliation Modalities

Telephonic conciliations were introduced as an early-intervention mechanism to resolve disputes as close to the point of referral as possible. This initiative enabled the Council to engage parties timeously and reduce delays associated with traditional in-person processes. As Council processes continued to evolve, virtual hearings were subsequently introduced to further optimise digitalisation efforts and enhance the efficiency, accessibility, and credibility of dispute resolution proceedings. This period also marked the transition of responsibility for the conducting of all conciliations to the Resident Panellist Unit, further centralising the function and contributing to greater consistency, efficiency, and cost containment in conciliation processes.

4.3.2. Establishment of the Resident Panellist Unit

The Resident Panellist Unit was formally established during the 2023/24 period to strengthen the Council's capacity to hear conciliations as early as possible, in most instances even within periods shorter than the legislated 30-day timeframe. In addition to this function, the unit is responsible for dealing with all applications prior to a matter being assigned to a commissioner, thereby streamlining processes, and reducing delays in the dispute resolution cycle.

The unit also assisted with the perusal of arbitration awards and rulings to ensure that quality, legally sound documents are issued by the Council. Through the internalisation of these functions and the reduced reliance on external processes, the Resident Panellist Unit has contributed to significant cost savings for the Council. These savings, which include reductions in commissioner deployment, travel, and administrative costs, are reflected and detailed earlier in this report.

4.3.3. Advancement of Enforcement and Dispute Characterisation Frameworks

The signing of the Enforcement Resolution (Resolution 02 of 2023) marked a significant milestone in strengthening dispute management processes. The resolution promotes a substantive assessment of the true nature of disputes at an early stage, contributing to more appropriate referrals and, indirectly, a reduction in overall referral volumes. In parallel, a comprehensive enforcement process was developed and implemented to support compliance with Council outcomes.

4.3.4. Stakeholder Education and Capacity-Building Initiatives

A series of case law webinars, publications, and workshops were conducted to enhance stakeholder understanding of key legal developments and dispute resolution processes. In addition, short videos on relevant case law were recorded and disseminated to the public through digital platforms, broadening access to information and promoting legal awareness among parties.

4.3.5. Dispute Resolution Committee Engagement

Dispute Resolution Committee meetings were convened on a regular basis, providing a structured platform for parties to deliberate on systemic issues affecting dispute management. These engagements contributed to improved alignment, problem-solving, and collaboration between stakeholders.

4.3.6. Optimisation of Resources Through Virtual Processes

The introduction of telephonic conciliations and virtual hearings enhanced operational efficiency, particularly in circumstances where there were shortages of commissioners or where matters were geographically dispersed. Commissioners were able to hear cases remotely without the need for travel, resulting in a reduction in overall case life cycles and significant savings in travel-related costs.

4.3.7. Improved Accessibility Through the Portal and E-Referral System

The development of an online Portal and e-referral form significantly enhanced accessibility to Council processes. The Portal promotes transparency and empowers parties to monitor the progress of their cases in real time, improving confidence in Council systems and processes.

4.3.8. Regulatory and Policy Development Initiatives

The Dispute Resolution Rules were reviewed to align Council processes with industry standards and best practice. Draft Picketing Rules were drafted and tabled as part of ongoing efforts to regulate and clarify picketing processes within the public service. In addition, targeted workshops



were conducted to educate and inform parties on newly signed resolutions and procedural changes.

4.3.9 Conclusion

The Resident Panellist Unit has significantly strengthened the PSCBC's internal dispute resolution capacity by improving turnaround times, enhancing quality assurance, and reducing reliance on external commissioners. The Unit's expanded role in conciliations, arbitrations, applications, and quality control has contributed to operational efficiency and substantial cost savings, while the introduction of virtual processes has improved accessibility and stakeholder participation. Despite challenges such as declining referral volumes and jurisdictional complexities, the Unit has demonstrated adaptability and value in supporting dispute prevention and resolution. As the PSCBC enters the next strategic cycle, the continued development of the Resident Panellist Unit will remain essential in promoting efficient, credible, and sustainable dispute management.

A network diagram in the top-left corner featuring a cluster of blue nodes connected by thin lines, set against a background of white and light gray geometric shapes.

STRATEGIC MONITORING, EVALUATION AND RESEARCH

A 3D-style graphic of a spiral, composed of dark blue and white segments, positioned to the right of the title text.A network diagram in the bottom-right corner, similar to the one in the top-left, with blue nodes and connecting lines, set against a background of white and light gray geometric shapes.

STRATEGIC MONITORING, EVALUATION AND RESEARCH

5.1 Strategic Objective

The Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation and Research (SMER) Unit within the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) plays an important role by providing the organisation with strategic direction, planning, monitoring performance, evaluation of programmes, and research oversight. The SMER unit is responsible for coordinating the development and implementation of the PSCBC Strategic Plan, Operational plan, and Annual Performance Plan to ensure alignment of PSCBC mandate and objectives.

The SMER unit also promotes organisational coherence, supports Council informed decision-making, through research improving the ability of the Council to respond proactively to emerging labour relations trends within the public. Furthermore, the SMER unit is also responsible for continuous monitoring and evaluation of all PSCBC programmes, projects, and public sectoral activities to assess performance, impact, and value for money.

The SMER support the development of Council performance indicators; conduct monthly monitoring and periodic evaluation of projects; and produce analytical and labour reports in alignment with the council's needs. The research and evaluation reports and outputs further contribute to policy development within public sector, improved collective bargaining, and dispute management initiatives thereby reinforcing the mandate of PSCBC to promote sound labour relations through collective bargaining; improve dispute management across public service; advancing and influencing change in the public service labour market environment.

5.2 PSCBC Strategy 2020-2025 Implementation

The implementation of the PSCBC Strategy (2020–2025) focused on translating the strategic objectives of the Council into actionable programmes and operational plans that support effective collective bargaining, dispute management, and labour relations stability within the public service.

This is achieved through aligning annual performance plans, public sectoral work programmes, and organisational resources with the strategic priorities of the Council. The emphasis is on improving collective bargaining, dispute prevention, and improving stakeholder engagement to Ensure The Effective Execution Of Strategic Interventions.

5.3 Strategic Partnerships

The PSCBC actively pursued strategic partnerships with key institutions and stakeholders operating within labour and public service sector to advance research, policy development, collective bargaining, and dispute management during the implementation period. The Council engaged with organisations such as the International Labour Organization (ILO), and the Public Service Sector Education and Training Authority (PSETA), as well as participating in various national and international labour relations forums.

The engagements included participation in conferences such as the South African Labour Law Conference and the African Labour Law Society Conference in South Africa, as well as the ILERA Africa Conferences hosted in, Zambia. As part of these initiatives, the Council developed and presented conference papers for platforms including the National Association of Bargaining Councils, the African Labour Law Conference, and ILERA Africa in Zambia, thereby contributing to thought leadership and knowledge sharing within the labour relations and public service environment.

Efforts were made to formalise a strategic partnership with NEDLAC in line with the implementation of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2022. This objective was not fully achieved during the period under review. However, the partnership with PSETA proved effective and yielded tangible outcomes, including the implementation of joint research projects that supported the post-training evaluation of the public administration.

Further engagement with PSETA also resulted in the development of a policy and planning curriculum, strengthening skills development and institutional capacity within the public service. These strategic partnerships led to the improvement of research profile of the PSCBC, supported evidence-based decision-making that benefited public service, and reinforced the role of the council in promoting effective labour relations and continuous learning in the public service.

5.3 SMER Support Provision

5.3.1 Policy Development Support

The unit provided policy development support to other PSCBC units to ensure that the organisational policies are aligned with legislative requirements, governance standards, and best practice within the public service. Through collaborative engagement internal controls, there has been improved operational efficiency, and enhancing accountability and risk management within the PSCBC.

5.3.2 Support to Provincial Chambers

The unit provided support to the Mpumalanga Provincial Chamber in the development of its operational plans and the coordination of skills audit. The support aimed at improving the planning and organisational capacity to identify skills gaps and to inform targeted interventions. Through this support, there was improved operational effectiveness in the implementation of Provincial Chamber's activities aligned with the broader PSCBC strategic objectives and governance frameworks of the PSCBC.

5.3.3 Monitoring the Implementation of Collective Agreements

The unit actively monitored the implementation of collective agreements in collaboration with Collective Bargaining Unit concluded between 2010 and 2026 on a quarterly basis to assess progress and compliance across the public service. The monitoring process enabled the Council to track implementation, identification of challenges, and ensure the employer implement the signed agreements. While the majority of collective agreements were fully implemented, some were only partially implemented due to outstanding clauses, and a limited number of agreements

remained unimplemented. The monitoring outcomes provide valuable insights to support accountability, inform engagements with stakeholders, and strengthen the overall effectiveness of collective bargaining processes.

5.3.4 Automation of the PSCBC Monitoring System

The automation of the PSCBC Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) system on the Collab has been initiated and yet to be completed. The development and implementation of the automation system is at the advanced stage. The system is critical because it is intended to improve efficiency, accuracy, and timeliness of monitoring and evaluation processes by enabling systematic data capture, tracking, and reporting of performance information.

5.4 Research and Publication Projects

5.4.1 Development Of Research Projects

In advancing both the current and future research within the areas of labour relations, collective bargaining, dispute management, and overall operation within the public service, the unit undertook and supported a range of research initiatives that informed strategic planning, and evidence-based decision-making within the Council. The research function played a critical role in generating knowledge to support policy formulation, improve collective bargaining processes, and advance dispute resolution management, thereby improving the contribution of PSCBC to a stable and effective public service labour relations environment.

The unit successfully undertook and completed several research projects during the period in 2025. These research projects' deliverables included the compilation of concept notes and research proposals; the execution of empirical research, data collection and analysis; and the producing research reports. These research outputs provided valuable insights into emerging trends and challenges within the public service and labour sector which enabled the council to make informed decisions that contributed to the well-being and effectiveness of the public service.

Table 1: Research projects concluded include:

List of completed research projects	
1) Council Gender mainstreaming assessment report 2) African Labour law conference report 2023 3) Multiple union membership report 2023 4) Decent work and challenges in the South African public service 5) Collective bargaining in the public service: unveiling lessons for the future. 6) Agency payers report 7) Levy payers report. 8) Implementation Evaluation of Public Summit Declaration concept 9) Dispute management research concept. 10)Public administration graduates' longitudinal study 11)Analysis of the high court ruling on parental leave 12)Assessing the City of Tshwane Strike and its implications 13)Assessment of Arbitration/Conciliation Referral Systems in PSCBC and Sector Councils: An In-depth Exploration of Trade Union Perspectives and Empowerment Strategies	14)Pay gap research. 15)Dispute management. 16)Trade union membership 17)Development of concept notes and research proposals 18)Public administration graduates' longitudinal study 19)Dispute management Referral system 20)Quarterly reports on Analysis of Mpumalanga Grievances and Misconduct 21)Assessment of Public Administration Procurement Program Learner's withdrawal 22)Evaluating the Implementation of BMA conditions of service 23)Analysis of Trade union membership trends 2024' 24)BMA survey 25)Mpumalanga Chambers skills gap 26)Evaluation of the PSCBC CSR projects

5.4.2 Book Publication

The unit made a significant contribution to the publication of the book titled *From Struggle to Structure: One Agreement at a Time-30 Years of Labour Relations*. The book provide a synopsis of how labour relations in south Africa was affected by the apartheid laws pre 1994, where only the white minority enjoyed labour relations while the majority of the African workers were denied the rights. It then looks at the strides made to promote labour peace, better working conditions of public servants and the freedom of association. The book, also outline the struggle the workers in the public service faced and how the South African constitution and labour relations act transformed how workers were viewed at the work place and the improvement of policies and collective bargaining processes that led to 30 years of improved social dialogue, labour peace and the signing of various agreements in the public service. The various lessons learnt through the PSCBC provide best practices across the globe and in Africa of how public service can be tower of hope for public servants. The unit played a critical role in the publication of the book through research inputs, content, analysis, data verification, and editorial support.

5.5 Parliamentary Group and Bills Monitoring

5.5.1 Parliamentary Monitoring Group

PSCBC actively monitor submissions made to Parliament each financial year on bills related to public service labour relations. The unit assist in the submissions tracking whether they were duly considered before the final amendment, approval by Parliament, and signing into law by the President. The aim of the monitoring group initiative was to ensures that the council actively engage with legislative processes, and that the interests of public service employees and employer were effectively represented in the formulation and enactment of labour-related legislations.

5.5.2 Parliamentary Bills Monitoring

PSCBC actively monitored key parliamentary bills affecting public service labour relations, including the Public Administration Bill and the Public Service Amendment Bill during the 2023/24 financial year period. The monitoring process involved tracking the progress of these bills through various parliamentary stages to ensure that the submissions and recommendations made by the council were duly considered before amendments were finalised and the bills were enacted into law.

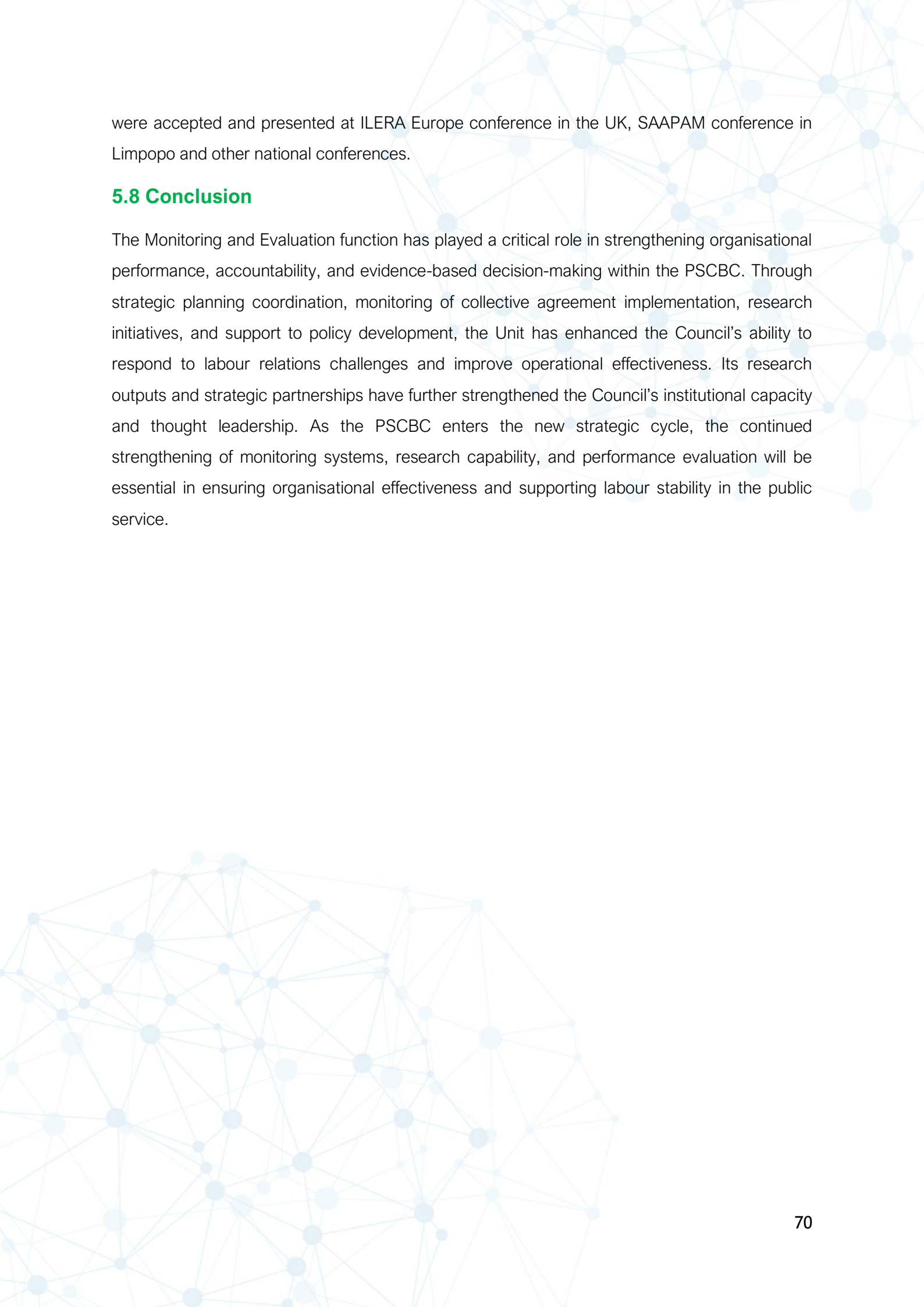
The objective of the monitoring process was to ensure that council play its role in protecting the rights and interests of public service employees and while ensuring that implemented legislative aligns with sound ILO labour relations principles and the strategic objectives of the Council.

5.6 SMER Staff Capacity Building

The Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation, and Research team participated in series of targeted capacity-building trainings for M and E skills development, knowledge empowerment and professional competence purposes. SMER staff members participated in Monitoring and Evaluation conferences, different trainings, internal capacity-building workshops, and weekly M&E sessions, which provided ongoing opportunities for learning, knowledge sharing, and skills development. Examples include Afrea and SAMEA.

5.7 Conference Papers Presentation (5 Years)

The PSCBC contributed to knowledge sharing through conducting research, compiling, and delivering presentation of conference papers on key labour and socio-economic issues. Topics presented included *Collective Bargaining in South Africa: Maturing Stakeholder Engagements*, *The Impact of Labour Relations on Socio-Economic Transformation*, *Labour Relations*, *National Health Insurance*, and *Youth Unemployment in South Africa*. Abstracts and conference papers



were accepted and presented at ILERA Europe conference in the UK, SAAPAM conference in Limpopo and other national conferences.

5.8 Conclusion

The Monitoring and Evaluation function has played a critical role in strengthening organisational performance, accountability, and evidence-based decision-making within the PSCBC. Through strategic planning coordination, monitoring of collective agreement implementation, research initiatives, and support to policy development, the Unit has enhanced the Council's ability to respond to labour relations challenges and improve operational effectiveness. Its research outputs and strategic partnerships have further strengthened the Council's institutional capacity and thought leadership. As the PSCBC enters the new strategic cycle, the continued strengthening of monitoring systems, research capability, and performance evaluation will be essential in ensuring organisational effectiveness and supporting labour stability in the public service.

The background features a complex geometric pattern of interlocking triangles in shades of white and light gray. In the top-left and bottom-right corners, there are dark blue circular shapes. Two light blue network diagrams, consisting of interconnected dots and lines, are positioned in the top-left and bottom-right areas. A central horizontal band contains a green patterned background with the text "CORPORATE SERVICES" in dark blue. To the right of the text is a stylized logo made of dark blue and white curved lines.

**CORPORATE
SERVICES**

CORPORATE SERVICES

6.1 Overview

The Constitution of the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council provides for the functions and powers of the Council in relation to the finances, which are as follows:

- Establish and administer a fund to be utilized for resolving disputes, collective bargaining and general administration of the Council.
- Raise, borrow, lend, levy and invest funds

6.2 Financial Committee

The Financial Committee has been established as a sub-Committee of the Council. The role of the Finance Committee is to scrutinise the financial activities of the Council and to make recommendations to the Executive Committee on these activities.

The Duties of the Financial Committee listed below are found in the Finance Policy and Procedure Manual

- Meet on a quarterly basis;
- Formulate financial policies and procedures;
- Recommend practical ways of implementing these policies;
- Review budgets and recommend to the Council;
- Review financial statements and ensure that financial policies and procedures are adhered to;
- Discuss the audited financial statements and management report with the auditors;
- Consider and recommend the acquisition of capital expenditure items within the budget;
- Discuss and manage the expenditure of special projects; and
- Cash flow management (including treasury functions).

6.3 Meetings

The Financial Committee held the following meetings during 2020 - 2025 period:

	YEAR 2020				YEAR 2021			YEAR 2022				YEAR 2023			YEAR 2024		
	04-Jun-19	03-Oct-19	16-Oct-19	03-Mar-20	26-Jun-20	21-Oct-20	15-Feb-21	02-Jun-21	31-Aug-21	14-Sept-21	16-Feb-22	14-Jun-22	15-Sept-22	03-Oct-22	02-May-23	23-Oct-23	19-Mar-24
Chairperson	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Vice-Chairperson Employer	✓	✓	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Vice-Chairperson Labour	-	✓	-	-	-	-	-	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	-
NEHAWU	✓	-	✓	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	-	✓	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
POPCRUI	-	✓	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	-
SADTU	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
DENOSA	✓	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	-
DPSA	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
DPSA	✓	✓	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
DPSA	-	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
National Treasury	-	-	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	-

6.4 Financial analysis

Total Income – Levy Account

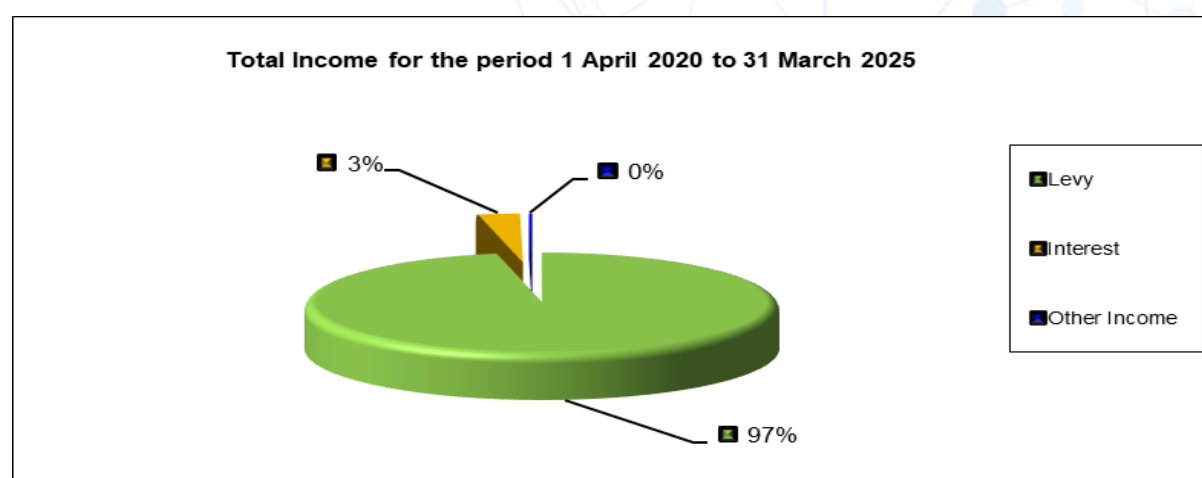
Over the five-year strategic cycle, 2020–2025, the Council's income base remained stable and highly predictable, with income primarily derived from levies. Total income for the period is categorised as follows:

- 96.8% was generated out of the levies from the public service as per Resolution 2 of 2013,
- 3.0% was generated from interest earned on levies and accumulated reserves,
- 0.2% was generated from other income sources.

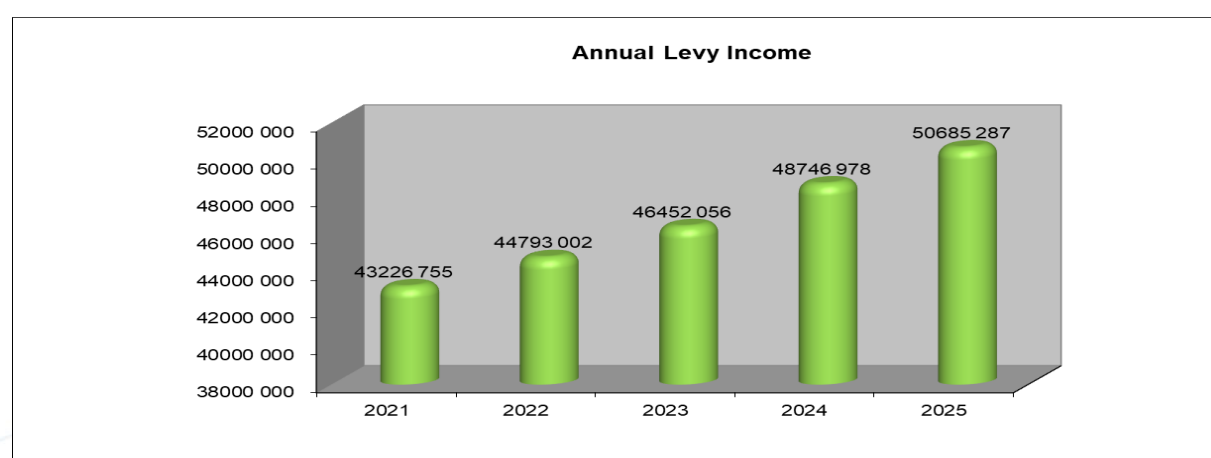
Below income composition highlights the Council's continued reliance on levy income as its primary funding source and exposes the sustainability risks associated with a fixed levy applied uniformly across approximately 1.2 million public servants.

In response, Council resolved at its previous Strategic Planning Session to review the levy funding model and explore the introduction of a progressive, salary linked levy formula, whereby higher-income earners contribute a marginally higher percentage than lower-income earners. While a levy funding increase has been approved by the Council during the reporting strategic cycle, a sustainable levy funding model has not yet been implemented.

The previous Strategic Planning proposed funding model therefore remains a strategic priority for further consideration and potential implementation in the next strategic cycle, with the objective of strengthening the Council's long-term financial sustainability and resilience.



The graph below illustrates the annual adjustments to the PSCBC levy over the period under review. These adjustments were implemented in line with National Treasury's projected year-on-year Consumer Price Index (CPI), as provided for in Resolution 2 of 2013.



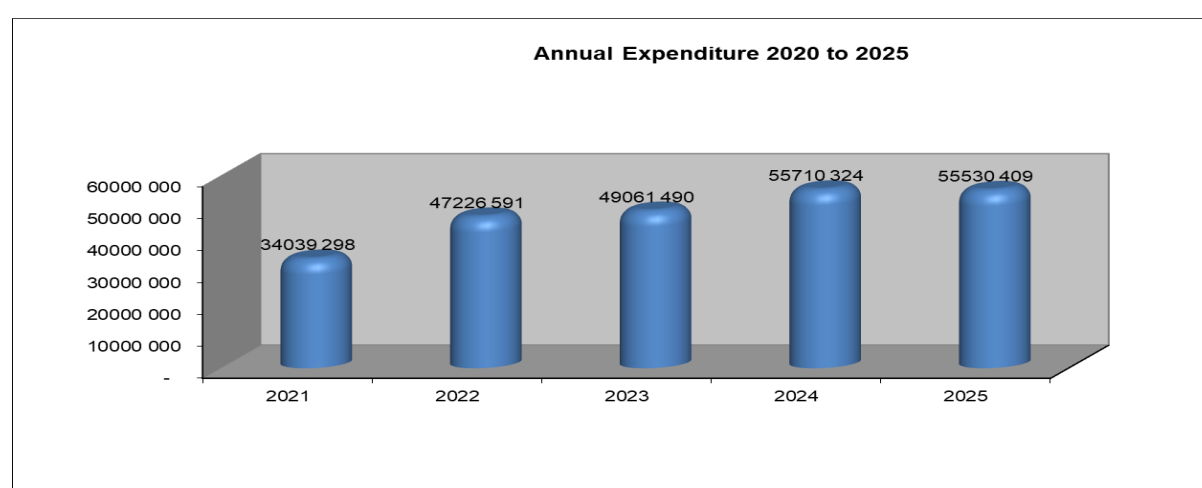
6.5 Total Expenditure – Levy Account

The annual expenditure graph below reflects the Council's trends over the 2020–2025 strategic cycle. A steady upward trajectory in expenditure is evident across the period, largely driven by inflationary pressures and the implementation of Council approved strategic and operational programmes.

Expenditure growth remained aligned with approved budgets and was supported by annual levy adjustments implemented in accordance with National Treasury's projected Consumer Price Index (CPI), as provided for in PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2013. This enabled the Council to continue fulfilling its mandate and operational responsibilities without compromising service delivery.

However, the analysis shows that the fixed levy model limited the Council's ability to manage ongoing cost pressures. While expenditure increases were planned and controlled, the model did not generate sufficient income to cover all strategic approved projects without relying on accumulated reserves.

This has highlighted a structural weakness in the current funding model, supporting the Council's decision to review the levy framework. As a result, a salary linked and progressive levy model is being considered to improve income growth and fund future programmes without reducing reserves.



6.6 Key Financial Indicators

Below graph presents a summary of key financial indicators extracted from the Council's audited annual financial statements over the five-year strategic cycle.

The analysis reflects relative stability in total assets, indicating that the Council maintained a sound financial position and asset base throughout the period under review. Notwithstanding this stability, the Council recorded operating deficits and negative cash flows from operations during the latter part of the strategic cycle, resulting in a gradual decline in accumulated reserves.

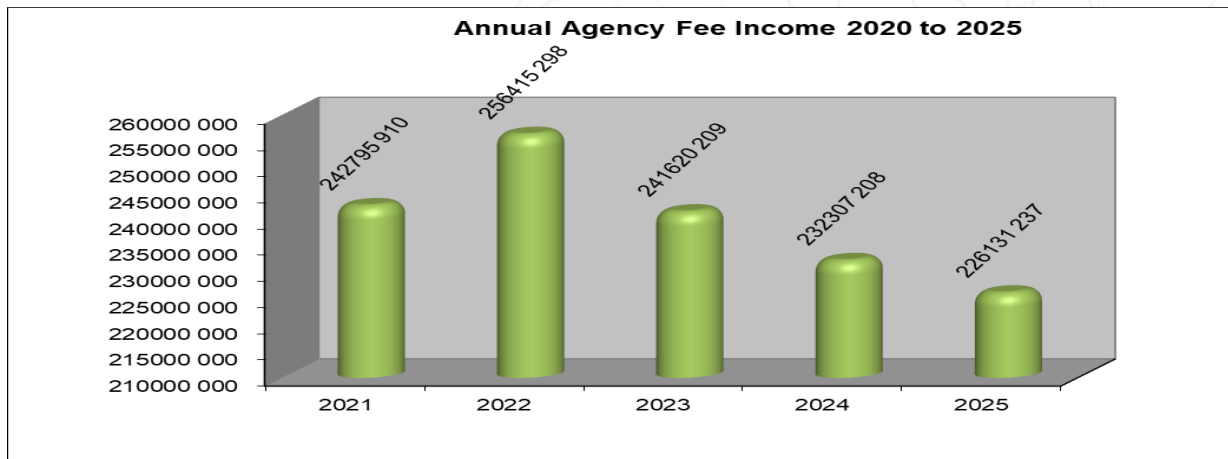
These trends do not reflect weaknesses in financial governance, cost containment measures or budgetary control, but rather depict the limitations of the existing fixed levy funding model in responding to sustained expenditure pressures over time. The reliance on accumulated reserves to fund operational shortfalls, while managed and deliberate, is not a sustainable long-term strategy.

Accordingly, the financial indicators provide a clear evidence base for the Council's strategic resolution to review the current levy funding model. The proposed introduction of a progressive, salary-linked levy structure remains a key strategic intervention under consideration for the next strategic cycle, aimed at strengthening cash flow sustainability, protecting reserves, and enhancing the Council's long-term financial resilience.

5 Year Financial Performance						
Key Financial Indicators	FY 2025 Actual	FY 2024 Actual	FY 2023 Actual	FY 2022 Actual	FY 2021 Actual	Accumulated Reserves
Levy Income	50 685 287	48 746 978	46 452 056	44 793 002	43 226 755	2022
Investment and Other income	2 782 735	2 715 789	2 195 629	2 738 993	1 314 160	R57.0 Million
Operating Expenses	(55 572 800)	(55 710 324)	(49 025 634)	(47 226 591)	(34 039 298)	2023
Net Surplus/(Deficit)	(2 104 778)	(4 247 558)	(377 949)	305 404	10 501 616	R56.7 Million
Accumulated Surplus Reserves	50 362 352	52 467 130	56 714 687	57 092 637	56 787 233	2024
Total Assets	53 919 644	56 334 082	60 383 722	62 075 651	59 671 917	R52.4 Million
Total Liabilities	3 557 292	3 866 952	3 669 035	4 983 014	2 884 684	2025
						R50.3 Million

6.7 Agency Shop Fee Account – Disbursements to Admitted Trade Unions

The graph below illustrates the annual distribution of agency shop fees to admitted trade unions in accordance with PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2010. The Council continued to administer and disburse agency fees in line with Resolution 2 of 2010 throughout the period under review.



6.8 PSCBC Agency Fee Administration Income

The PSCBC currently receives an annual administration fee of R7 200 for the administration of agency shop fees, in terms of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 1998. This fee covers the receipt of agency fees in trust, monthly distribution to the admitted trade unions, investigation and reconciliation of shortfall variances, quarterly reporting to trade unions, and compliance oversight.

Since the adoption of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 1998, the scope, complexity, and governance requirements associated with the administration of agency fees have increased, while the administration fee has remained unchanged for over two decades:

Source of Income	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Agency Fee Admin	R7 200.00	R7 200.00	R7 200.00	R7 200.00	R7 200.00

Compliance: Agency Fee Accounts

The PSCBC requires Trade Unions to submit audited financial statements of the separate agency fee accounts by June of each year. Those Unions which do not meet the deadline are entitled to request an extension until the end of September. Should Unions not submit such statements, agency fee payments are forfeited until such statements are submitted to the Council.

The Trade Unions audited financial statements are submitted to the Council's auditors. Council auditors report on the usage of funds, to ensure compliance with Section 25 (3) (d) of the Labour Relations Act and PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2005.

6.9 PROCUREMENT, LOGISTICS AND FACILITIES

6.9.1 Strategic Programme: PSCBC Office Building Development

– Die Hoewes Ext 213

During the 2020–2025 strategic cycle, the Procurement, Logistics and Facilities function played a central role in advancing the Council’s long-term infrastructure investment strategy through the development of a new PSCBC office building on vacant land measuring approximately 10 992 square metres, originally acquired in January 2016 for future office development.

The acquisition and development of the vacant land forms part of the PSCBC’s long-term vision to expand employment capacity, strengthen institutional capability, and enhance its ability to fulfil its mandate to the public sector. The proposed office development further includes the establishment of in-house conferencing facilities, aimed at reducing long-term conferencing costs and providing shared infrastructure for Sector Councils.

A significant portion of the strategic cycle was dedicated to navigating complex municipal town planning processes, including the consolidation of the twenty residential erven into a single development property and the rezoning of land from residential to commercial use, which were critical prerequisites for project commencement.

Progress Over the Strategic Cycle

2020/2021 Financial Year – Project Initiation and Professional Team Establishment

During the 2020/2021 financial year, the Council initiated formal development processes for the new PSCBC office building under the Die Hoewes Ext 213 development project.

An advertisement was placed in national print media inviting Built Environment professionals to register on the PSCBC supplier database. This step ensured transparency, competitiveness, and compliance with procurement governance requirements.

The PSCBC Executive Committee approved the appointment of a Construction Project Manager to serve as a subject matter expert responsible for overseeing project implementation in line with Council directives. The appointment was conducted in accordance with industry standards prescribed by the South African Council for the Project and Construction Management Profession and relevant Government Gazette guidelines. The Project Manager operates under the direction and governance oversight of the PSCBC Executive Committee.

Following a comprehensive bid evaluation process, professional service providers were appointed in key disciplines:

- Architectural Services: Consultium Architects and Urban Designers (Pty) Ltd
- Quantity Surveying: Morei Matji and Associates CC
- Civil and Structural Engineering: MSBR Consulting (Pty) Ltd

A total of 104 applications were received from industry professionals, demonstrating strong market interest and ensuring a competitive and transparent appointment process.

6.9.2 2021/2022 Financial Year – Expansion of Professional Services and Municipal Challenges

During the 2021/2022 period, the PSCBC expanded the professional project team through the appointment of additional specialist consultants:

- Electrical Engineering: HAMSA Consulting Engineers (Pty) Ltd
- Mechanical Engineering: IX Engineers (Pty) Ltd
- Wet Services Engineering: IX Engineers (Pty) Ltd

During this phase, the Council encountered significant municipal planning challenges related to the rezoning of the development land from residential to commercial use. The rezoning process was identified as potentially lengthy and complex, with estimated approval timelines of eight to twelve months.

Further complications arose when the City of Tshwane identified that ERF566 constituted a servitude owned by the Villa iL Roseto Homeowners Association. To address this issue, Special Powers of Attorney were executed, enabling the PSCBC to secure rights over ERF566.

6.9.3 2022/2023 Financial Year – Statutory Submissions and Technical Approvals

During the 2022/2023 financial year, the Council, through its appointed town planners, submitted comprehensive statutory documentation to the City of Tshwane in support of rezoning and consolidation applications. These included:

- Engineering services reports covering roads, stormwater, water, sanitation, and electricity;
- A detailed Site Development Plan (SDP);

- Consent documentation from the Villa iL Roseto Homeowners Association; and
- Title deeds for ERF882 and ERF566.

This phase marked significant technical progress in meeting regulatory requirements.

6.9.4 2023/2024 Financial Year – Municipal Processing and Regulatory Dependencies

During the 2023/2024 financial year, the City of Tshwane advised that the consolidation application would remain pending until the rezoning application had been approved. As a result, project timelines were influenced by external regulatory dependencies beyond the Council's direct control.

Despite these delays, the PSCBC continued to engage with municipal authorities and service providers to ensure regulatory compliance and maintain project momentum.

6.9.5 2024/2025 Financial Year – Rezoning and Consolidation Milestones Achieved

During the final year of the strategic cycle, the Council achieved significant project milestones:

- The City of Tshwane approved the rezoning of ERF882 and ERF566,
- The consolidation of the two erven was subsequently approved,
- The properties were formally consolidated into a single development property, ERF948.

These approvals represent a major strategic breakthrough and effectively remove key regulatory barriers that had constrained project progression during earlier phases of the cycle.

6.10 Strategic Reflection and Positioning for the Next Cycle

Over the 2020–2025 strategic period, the Council successfully established governance and planning foundation for the office development project. Key achievements included the appointed multidisciplinary professional teams, navigated complex municipal planning and regulatory requirements, and secured critical statutory approvals.

While construction did not commence within the reporting cycle due to regulatory planning complexities inherent to large scale infrastructure development, the Council now enters the next strategic cycle with:

- Approved rezoning and consolidation rights;

- A consolidated development property (ERF948);
- Established professional and project governance structures; and
- Completion and approval of Phase 1 (Inception) and Phase 2 (Concept and Viability).

The focus for the upcoming strategic cycle will shift from regulatory compliance and planning towards project funding submission, project execution, contractor appointment, and construction commencement.



6.11 Conclusion

The Corporate Services function has provided a stable financial, infrastructure, and governance foundation to support the PSCBC's operations and long-term sustainability during the 2020–2025 strategic cycle. Despite financial pressures associated with the fixed levy funding model, the Council maintained financial stability, safeguarded its asset base, and continued to fund its strategic and operational priorities. Significant progress was also achieved in advancing the PSCBC office development project, positioning the Council for future institutional growth. However, the review of the levy funding model remains critical to ensuring long-term financial sustainability. Strengthening financial resilience, infrastructure development, and governance systems will remain key priorities in the next strategic cycle.

HUMAN RESOURCES

6.12. Strategic Human Capital Overview: 2020–2025

During the 2020–2025 strategic cycle, the PSCBC Human Resources function focused on strengthening organisational sustainability, workforce alignment, and institutional resilience within a constrained fiscal environment.

The period under review was characterised by:

- The need for organisational restructuring to align with strategic objectives; and
- The operational disruption caused by COVID-19.

Within this context, the Human Resources adopted a deliberate and risk-informed approach to workforce planning, prioritising critical capacity while maintaining staff retention, regulatory compliance, and organisational stability.

6.13. Organisational Work Study and Workforce Alignment

In response to Council's strategic direction, the PSCBC undertook a comprehensive organisational work study aimed at aligning its structure to its evolving mandate and operational requirements.

The project was completed on 1 April 2023 and resulted in:

- A revised organisational structure;
- The identification of critical and non-critical roles;
- Phased vacancy filling aligned to strategic priorities; and
- Improved role clarity and accountability.

The implementation of the revised structure was approached cautiously, taking into account financial sustainability considerations arising from the current fixed levy funding model.

6.14. Staff Retention: 2020 – 2025

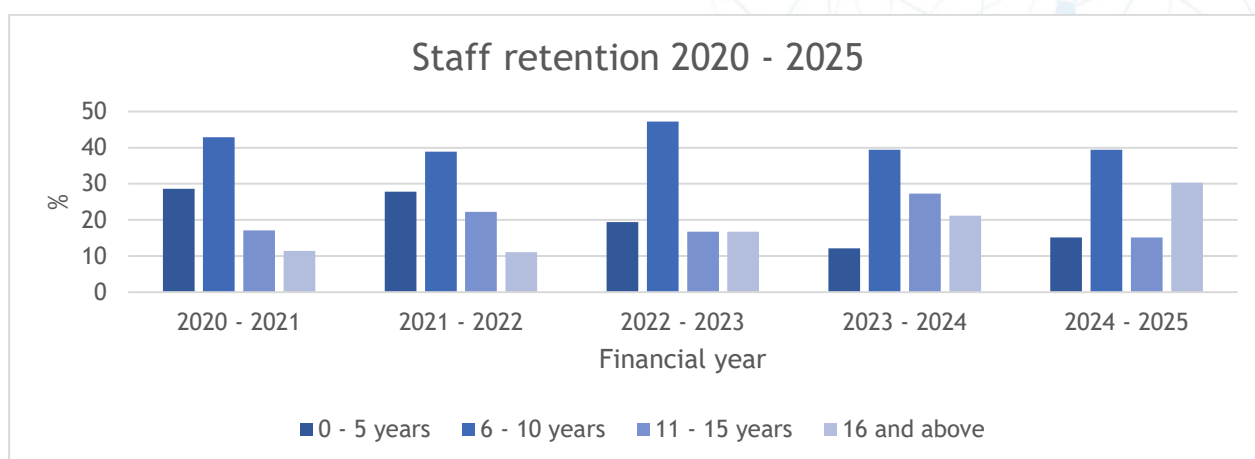
Staff retention remained a key strategic strength of the Council throughout the reporting period. The retention profile reflects institutional stability and the preservation of organisational knowledge, with a significant proportion of employees having long-term service with the Council.

The retention trends demonstrate:

- Low turnover across most years;
- Continuity in core operational roles; and
- Sustained institutional memory supporting effective service delivery.

This stability has enabled the Council to manage organisational changes while continuing to operate effectively.

The table below provides a synopsis of Council's staff retention, by order of years of service for the period under review.



6.15. Appointments and Terminations

Over the five-year cycle, appointments were implemented in a phased and prioritised manner.

While vacancies increased toward the latter part of the cycle, this trend reflects the implementation of the revised organisational structure, a deliberate decision to prioritise critical posts, financial sustainability constraints linked to the fixed levy funding model, and a cautious recruitment strategy aimed at containing long-term compensation obligations.

The increasing vacancy rate must therefore be understood as a controlled and strategic response to fiscal risk, rather than organisational instability.

Going forward, vacancy levels will need to be reassessed in the context of the proposed levy funding model reform.

Internship Programme and Graduate Development

In support of youth development and skills transfer, the PSCBC partnered with the PSETA to appoint seven (7) interns on a 24-month internship programme during the 2023–2024 and 2024–

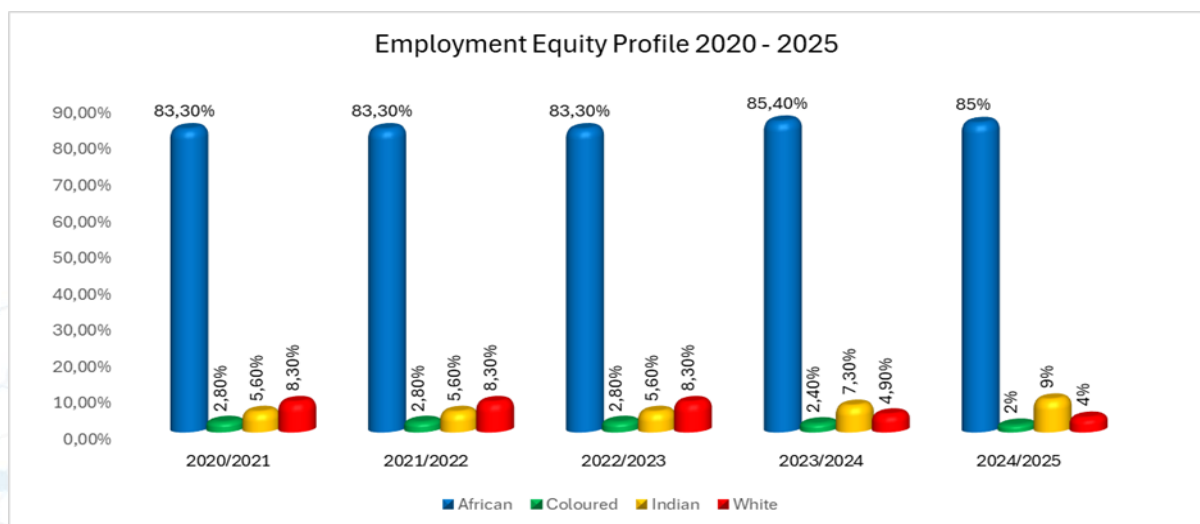
2025 financial years. These internships were partially funded by the PSETA and covered the following disciplines:

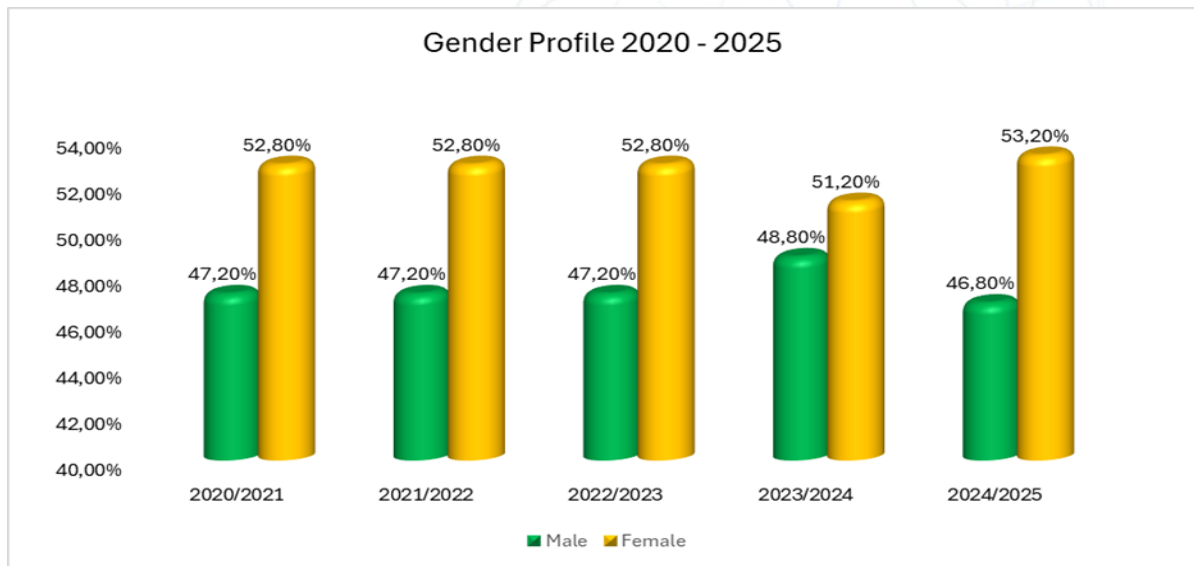
- Collective Bargaining
- Communications
- Information and Communication Technology
- Human Resources and
- Law

This initiative contributed to workforce renewal and helped advance the Council's transformation and development goals within fiscal constraints.

6.16. Profile Representation and Employment Equity

Throughout the strategic cycle, the Council monitored workforce representativity to ensure alignment with employment equity objectives. Employment equity and gender profiles were maintained and reviewed annually to support inclusive workforce planning and statutory compliance.





6.17. Skills Development

Skills development remained a central strategic investment area during the reporting period. Council expanded access to bursaries, NQF-aligned qualifications and targeted non-NQF learning interventions, in alignment with the [Skills Development Act](#), PSETA requirements, and long-term organisational capability needs.

6.18. Bursaries and Qualifications

Over the five-year cycle, the Council supported staff members across a wide range of academic and professional qualifications, with the majority successfully completed. These qualifications strengthened capacity in labour law, communications, public administration, HR, IT, finance, and governance.

Several postgraduate and doctoral programmes remain in progress, reflecting continued investment in senior and strategic capacity development.

6.19. NQF-Aligned Programmes (PSETA Partnership)

In collaboration with the PSETA, Council facilitated multiple NQF-aligned programmes, including:

- Labour and Dispute Prevention (NQF Level 6)
- Public Administration – Leadership (NQF Level 5)
- Public Administration – Procurement (NQF Level 5)

- Firefighting Techniques (NQF Level 1)

These programmes enhanced operational capability, compliance awareness, and dispute resolution capacity across the organisation.

Organisational Innovation and Automated Operations (Post-COVID Reform)

A defining feature of the 2020–2025 cycle was the institutionalisation of remote and digitally enabled operations.

6.20. Adoption of Remote Work Policy

Following the COVID-19 pandemic, Council formally adopted the PSCBC Remote Work Policy, transitioning from emergency remote arrangements to a structured hybrid operating framework.

The policy established governance controls relating to:

- Performance management.
- Approval and accountability structures.
- Information security compliance.
- Occupational health and safety considerations.

This reform enhanced flexibility while preserving governance integrity.

6.21. Automation of HR Processes

To support remote work and ensure continuity, the Council successfully implemented automation of key Human Resource processes, including:

- Electronic leave management systems.
- Automated performance management workflows.
- Secure document management platforms; and
- Enhanced ICT-enabled connectivity.

These innovations resulted in:

- Reduced paper-based administration.
- Improved audit trails and compliance oversight.
- Faster turnaround times; and
- Strengthened organisational resilience.

Importantly, these reforms were achieved within existing levy constraints, demonstrating prudent financial stewardship and strategic agility.

6.22. Employee Wellness: 2020-2025

Employee wellness was prioritised as a strategic enabler of productivity, morale, and retention.

Wellness initiatives implemented during the cycle included:

- Annual Staff Year-End Functions to promote collegiality and appreciation;
- Annual Family Days, subject to budget availability;
- Wellness Wednesdays, focusing on workplace fitness and wellbeing;
- MTN Walk the Talk, promoting physical health, teamwork, and resilience.

These initiatives contributed to a positive organisational culture and strengthened employee engagement.

6.23. Policy Review And Compliance

The Council maintained full statutory and regulatory compliance throughout the strategic cycle.

In response to emerging risks and organisational changes, several policies were adopted or reviewed, including:

- Adopted Standard Operating Procedure on COVID-19;
- Adopted PSCBC Policy on Work Arrangements;
- Adopted Remote Work Policy
- Adopted Delegation of Authority and
- Reviewed HR, Leave, Disciplinary, Performance Management and Incentive Policies

The Council remained compliant with the requirements of:

- The Department of Employment and Labour;
- SARS; and
- PSETA

Strategic Reflection and Outlook

The 2020–2025 strategic cycle consolidated the PSCBC's human capital foundation through:

- Organisational restructuring.
- Fiscal discipline in workforce management.
- Investment in professional development.
- Digital transformation and remote enablement; and
- Sustained regulatory compliance.

As the Council enters the next strategic cycle, the following priorities require strategic focus:

- Addressing vacancy levels in critical roles;
- Embedding outcomes of the organisational work study;
- Enhancing leadership depth;
- Strengthening succession planning.
- Maintaining employee wellbeing and productivity.
- Leveraging digital systems for further operational efficiency; and
- Aligning workforce expansion plans to the proposed levy funding model reform.

The successful implementation of a reviewed and sustainable funding model will be pivotal in enabling the Council to stabilise vacancy levels, enhance capacity, and safeguard long-term institutional

6.24. Conclusion

The Human Resources function has played a pivotal role in strengthening organisational sustainability, workforce alignment, and institutional resilience during the 2020–2025 strategic cycle. Through the implementation of the organisational work study, restructuring of the organisational framework, and prioritisation of critical capacity, the PSCBC has ensured that its human capital remains aligned with its strategic objectives despite financial and operational constraints. The function has further supported staff retention, enhanced role clarity, and maintained organisational stability during a period marked by structural transition and external disruptions. As the Council enters the next strategic cycle, continued focus on strategic workforce planning, talent development, and organisational capacity will be essential to support the PSCBC's evolving mandate and ensure its long-term effectiveness and sustainability.

The background features a complex geometric pattern of interlocking triangles in shades of gray, creating a 3D effect. Overlaid on this are two network motifs: a cluster of blue nodes connected by thin lines in the top-left and bottom-right corners, and a central horizontal band with a repeating geometric pattern. A dark blue curved shape is in the top-left corner, and a dark blue semi-circle is in the bottom-right corner.

INFORMATION COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY



INFORMATION, COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)

Overview

The Information Communication Technology (ICT) Unit was established through the integration of the former Communication and Information Technology units as part of the PSCBC's organisational structure. This integration was intended to create a coordinated and strategic function that supports the Council's mandate, visibility, and operational effectiveness.

The objective of the ICT Unit is to cultivate a unified and sustainable brand image for the Council by conveying clear, consistent, and concise messages through appropriate communication channels. This objective is directed at building a strong and recognisable brand presence for the Council, thereby enhancing its visibility at both national and international levels. The ICT Unit is structured around two core components, namely Communications and Information Technology.

The communications component encompasses a broad range of strategic functions that support the achievement of the Council's objectives. These include communication and branding, media relations, advertising, strategic brand communication, social media management, corporate social responsibility (CSR), the resource centre, events management, stakeholder relations, and the development of strategic partnerships.

The information technology component focuses on two primary areas. The first is the maintenance and support of information technology systems and equipment, including both hardware and software components. The second is technological innovation, which involves identifying and addressing technological gaps while fostering a culture of innovation to support the Council's long-term growth and sustainability.

This report provides a comprehensive overview of the strategic activities undertaken within the communications component, followed by an in-depth examination of the information technology component. By presenting these areas separately, the report aims to ensure clarity and transparency regarding the scope of work, initiatives implemented, and achievements realised across both domains.

Through the implementation of targeted communication strategies and continuous technological advancement, the ICT Unit seeks to strengthen the Council's brand presence, enhance stakeholder engagement, and contribute to sustainable growth and positive impact within the communities served.

This section of the report further evaluates the contribution and impact of the ICT Unit on the Council's overall objectives, reach, and visibility, and outlines the key activities achieved during the 5 year reporting period. The report begins with an overall overview of the Unit and then provides feedback within the various subsections.

7.1. Strategic Evolution

Over the five-year period under review, the Communications and later the Information Communication and Technology (ICT) function demonstrated significant strategic maturation and institutional relevance within the Council. The evolution from a standalone Communications Section into an integrated ICT Unit reflects the Council's recognition of communication and technology as critical enablers of organisational effectiveness, visibility, and stakeholder engagement.

During the early years of the period (2020/21 and 2021/22), the focus was predominantly on strengthening foundational communication systems, policies, and procedures. These frameworks provided consistency, coherence, and alignment in stakeholder engagement and public communication, ensuring that the Council's image and messaging were preserved and professionally managed. The emphasis on policy-driven operations established stability and enabled the section to respond effectively to both routine communication demands and emerging strategic priorities.

From 2022/23 onwards, the function shifted from foundational consolidation to strategic expansion and visibility. The Council's 25th anniversary milestone marked a pivotal point in brand positioning, with deliberate investment in rebranding, media engagement, promotional material, and physical branding assets. This period demonstrated the section's growing capacity to manage high-profile initiatives, respond to intense media scrutiny, particularly during wage negotiations and cultivate relationships with major national media platforms. The increased media footprint significantly enhanced the Council's public profile and credibility.

The formation of the integrated ICT Unit in 2023/24 and its continuation in 2024/25 represented a strategic turning point. By combining communications and information technology, the Council adopted a more holistic approach to brand management, digital communication, and operational support. This structural alignment enabled clearer coordination between messaging, digital platforms, and technological infrastructure, positioning the Council to better address modern communication demands and technological innovation. The dual focus on maintaining stable IT

systems while addressing technological gaps laid the groundwork for long-term digital transformation.

7.1.1 Key Strategic Strengths

One of the most notable strengths over the five-year period was the consistent alignment of communication activities with the Council's mandate and strategic objectives. The function demonstrated adaptability in response to organisational growth, public scrutiny, and changing communication environments. Strong governance through policies and procedures ensured credibility, consistency, and professionalism in stakeholder engagement.

The Council's growing media presence, particularly during complex and high-pressure periods (e.g. wage negotiations), showcased the section's ability to manage reputational risk and provide authoritative messaging. Strategic branding initiatives, milestone campaigns, and diversified communication channels contributed to improved national visibility and stakeholder awareness. The eventual integration of ICT strengthened institutional resilience by embedding communication within a broader technological and innovation-focused framework.

7.1.2 Key Strategic Weaknesses

Technological innovation, while acknowledged as a priority, remained uneven, with continued emphasis on maintenance rather than full digital optimisation. The reliance on reactive responses during high-profile events, such as wage negotiations, highlighted the need for more proactive communication planning, advanced digital analytics, and integrated crisis communication frameworks.

7.1.3. Strategic Outlook

Overall, the five-year period reflects a trajectory of growth, consolidation, and strategic repositioning. The Council now enters the next planning cycle with a more integrated ICT structure, a recognised public profile, and a solid governance foundation. Addressing capacity constraints, strengthening performance measurement, and accelerating digital innovation will be

critical to fully leveraging the strengths established during this period and mitigating the weaknesses identified.

7.2 Website

7.2.1 Strategic Context And Purpose

Over the five-year period under review, the PSCBC website evolved into a critical institutional asset, serving as the primary digital platform for information dissemination, stakeholder engagement, and brand positioning. The website functioned as the central repository and authoritative source of PSCBC information, operating continuously and without geographical limitation.

The strategic intent was to ensure that the website:

- Strengthened the public image and credibility of the Council;
- Provided timely, accurate, and consistent information to stakeholders;
- Supported transparency and accessibility in labour relations;
- Integrated seamlessly with social media and other communication platforms;
- Responded to changing communication needs, particularly during periods of disruption such as the COVID-19 pandemic.

7.2.2 Strategic Objectives Over The Five-Year Period

The website strategy was guided by the following long-term objectives:

- To establish the PSCBC website as the core communication hub supporting Council operations and stakeholder engagement.
- To ensure content uniformity and message alignment across all communication platforms, including social media.
- To expand digital reach and improve accessibility to PSCBC information at national and international levels.

- To strengthen analytics-driven decision-making through the monitoring of usage trends, visitor behaviour, and engagement patterns.
- To support organisational resilience by enabling uninterrupted access to information during periods of restricted physical engagement.

7.2.3. Performance Overview And Key Achievements

7.2.3.1. Growth in Website Usage and Reach

Between 2020/21 and 2024/25, the PSCBC website recorded consistently strong engagement, with significant growth observed during the early years of the COVID-19 pandemic and sustained usage thereafter.

- In 2020/21, total page views exceeded 556,000, with over 429,000 unique visitors, reflecting heightened reliance on digital platforms during lockdown restrictions.
- In 2021/22, website usage increased further, with page views surpassing 600,000 and visitors exceeding 486,000, confirming the website's role as a trusted source of information.
- In 2022/23 and 2023/24, the website transitioned from pandemic-driven spikes to more stabilised usage patterns, while still maintaining strong annual engagement above 350,000 page views.
- In 2024/25, the focus shifted towards new visitor acquisition, with over 81,000 new users, demonstrating continued relevance and reach among first-time audiences.

This sustained performance illustrates the successful institutionalisation of the website as a primary point of reference for PSCBC stakeholders.

7.2.3.2 Centralisation of Information and Content Consistency

A major achievement over the five-year period was the successful positioning of the website as the single source of truth for PSCBC information. Strategic emphasis was placed on ensuring that all content published on social media platforms linked back to the website, thereby increasing traffic and reinforcing credibility.

Uniformity across platforms was consistently maintained, ensuring that stakeholders received accurate, verified, and aligned messaging, regardless of the channel used.

7.2.3.3 Integration with Social Media Platforms

The website strategy was closely aligned with an expanding social media presence, particularly during 2020/21, when virtual engagement became essential.

Social media platforms, especially Facebook, were used to:

- Drive traffic to the website;
- Disseminate real-time updates;
- Encourage stakeholder interaction and dialogue.

The substantial growth in social media followers directly contributed to increased website visits, reinforcing the effectiveness of an integrated digital communication approach.

7.2.3.4 Stakeholder Accessibility and Demographic Reach

Analytics data demonstrates that the website successfully reached a diverse and geographically dispersed audience, with users accessing content from across South Africa and internationally. The demographic profile of users confirms strong engagement within the economically active age groups, particularly between 25 and 54 years, which aligns with the Council's core stakeholder base.

7.2.4 Key Strategic Achievements

Over the five-year period, the following strategic achievements were realised:

- The establishment of the PSCBC website as the primary digital communication and information platform.
- Sustained growth in website traffic and engagement, particularly during periods of national disruption.
- Successful integration of the website with social media platforms, strengthening two-way communication.

- Improved visibility and accessibility of Council information at both national and international levels.
- Consistent use of analytics to inform reporting and strategic oversight.

CHALLENGES EXPERIENCED

Despite notable successes, several challenges were identified over the reporting period:

- Fluctuations in website traffic in later years reflected changing stakeholder behaviour and increased competition for digital attention.
- Dependence on external platforms and internet accessibility limited reach among stakeholders in low-connectivity areas.
- The increasing demand for real-time updates placed pressure on internal content management and turnaround times.
- Data inconsistencies, including duplication in demographic reporting (e.g. city listings), highlighted the need for enhanced data validation and reporting controls.
- The absence of advanced interactive features limited deeper user engagement beyond information access.

7.2.5. Strategic Lessons Learnt

- The five-year period reinforced the importance of digital platforms as core operational tools, rather than supplementary communication channels.
- Consistency and credibility are critical in maintaining stakeholder trust.
- Integrated communication strategies significantly enhance reach and engagement.
- Data analytics must be supported by robust governance and quality assurance processes.
- Digital platforms require continuous enhancement to remain relevant and responsive to stakeholder expectations.

7.2.7. Strategic Direction Going Forward

Building on the achievements of 2020/21–2024/25, future website strategy should focus on:

- Enhanced user experience and accessibility;
- Improved data accuracy and reporting capabilities;
- Greater interactivity and stakeholder engagement tools;
- Continued alignment with broader ICT and communication strategies.

7.3 Social Media

7.3.1. Introduction and Strategic Overview

Over the five-year strategic period, social media evolved into one of the most critical communication and stakeholder-engagement tools of the PSCBC. Initially serving as a complementary communication channel, social media platforms became central to the Council's ability to inform, educate, promote dialogue, and strengthen institutional visibility, particularly during periods of national disruption and limited physical engagement.

The outbreak of the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020/21 fundamentally reshaped the PSCBC's communication approach. Lockdown restrictions and the suspension of physical events necessitated an immediate and strategic reliance on digital platforms. In response, the PSCBC adopted a structured and deliberate social media strategy that prioritised consistency, topical relevance, and stakeholder interaction. Over time, this approach matured into a multi-platform, data-driven communication system aligned with the Council's broader strategic objectives.

From 2021 onwards, the PSCBC expanded its digital footprint beyond Facebook and Twitter to include Instagram, LinkedIn, TikTok and YouTube, reflecting an intentional move toward audience segmentation, professional engagement, and multimedia storytelling. By the end of the five-year period, social media had become an institutional asset that supported collective bargaining communication, policy awareness, youth engagement, brand positioning, and public trust.

7.3.2 Key Strategic Achievements

A major achievement over the five-year period was the exponential growth in followers, reach, and engagement across all social media platforms. Facebook remained the dominant platform, with followers increasing steadily from approximately 16,000 in 2020/21 to over 31,000 by 2024/25. This growth reflected the effectiveness of daily and weekly content planning, topical messaging, and sustained engagement with labour-relations issues, wage negotiations, and Council activities.

Twitter (now X) emerged as a powerful real-time communication tool, particularly during high-interest periods such as wage negotiations, arbitration processes, and national policy announcements. The PSCBC significantly increased tweet volumes and impressions, reinforcing its relevance within the labour relations discourse and enabling direct, two-way engagement with stakeholders. Despite changes to the platform's operating model and branding, follower growth remained positive across the period.

The introduction and expansion of Instagram and LinkedIn represented a strategic diversification of communication channels. Instagram allowed the PSCBC to reach a younger and more visually engaged audience, while LinkedIn strengthened engagement with professionals, institutions, and policy stakeholders within government, labour, legal, and human-resources sectors. LinkedIn in particular recorded strong growth, increasing from initial adoption levels in 2021 to over 1,300 followers by 2024/25, demonstrating the Council's growing influence in professional networks.

The PSCBC also strengthened its video and multimedia presence through YouTube, increasing both content output and subscriber numbers. This supported the Council's objective of improving accessibility to information, capturing institutional milestones, and preserving organisational knowledge.

Another key achievement was the establishment of structured content planning, including weekly social media plans, scheduled posts, and responsive messaging informed by stakeholder feedback. This approach enhanced consistency, relevance, and algorithmic visibility, contributing to sustained growth and engagement across platforms.

7.3.3 Strategic Challenges Experienced

Despite the strong performance recorded over the five-year period, several challenges were encountered. One of the most significant was the resource-intensive nature of daily content creation, monitoring, and engagement. Maintaining consistent, high-quality output across multiple platforms placed increasing pressure on limited human and technical capacity.

The evolving nature of social media platforms also presented challenges. Algorithm changes, platform rebranding, and the introduction of subscription-based models, particularly on X (formerly Twitter)—required ongoing adaptation and strategic reassessment to maintain visibility and relevance without incurring additional costs.

Audience saturation and content fatigue posed a further challenge, particularly on mature platforms such as Facebook, where growth began to stabilise toward the latter years of the period. This highlighted the need for more innovative content formats, including video, storytelling, and interactive engagement.

While quantitative performance indicators such as followers and impressions were well tracked, the absence of a fully formalised impact-measurement framework limited the ability to assess qualitative outcomes, such as behavioural change, policy understanding, or long-term stakeholder perception.

7.3.4 Strategic Lessons and Maturation

The five-year period underscored the importance of planned, data-informed, and audience-specific communication. The PSCBC learned that relevance, consistency, and responsiveness are key drivers of digital engagement. The expansion into multiple platforms demonstrated that different audiences require tailored messaging approaches rather than a one-size-fits-all strategy.

The integration of social media with ICT and communications functions further strengthened operational efficiency, content quality, and innovation potential, positioning the Council to leverage emerging technologies and digital trends more effectively.

7.3.5 Conclusion

In conclusion, the PSCBC's social media strategy over the five-year period reflects a significant institutional transformation. From a supportive communication tool, social media has evolved into a strategic pillar that enhances transparency, stakeholder engagement, and organisational visibility.

Despite operating in a rapidly changing digital environment and under resource constraints, the PSCBC achieved sustained growth, broadened its digital footprint, and strengthened its brand presence across multiple platforms. The Council is now well positioned to further professionalise its digital communication strategy, strengthen impact measurement, and harness emerging technologies to support its mandate in the years ahead.

7.4 Events Management

7.4.1 Introduction and Strategic Overview

Over the five-year period under review, the PSCBC utilised strategic events as a key platform to advance its mandate, strengthen stakeholder relations, enhance visibility, and promote dialogue within the public service collective bargaining environment. Events hosted and supported by the PSCBC served as critical instruments for engagement, knowledge-sharing, policy alignment, and organisational positioning.

The period from 2020/21 to 2024/25 was characterised by unprecedented disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic, which necessitated a rapid shift in event planning, delivery models, and stakeholder engagement approaches. In response, the PSCBC demonstrated adaptability and innovation by transitioning from traditional physical events to virtual and hybrid formats, ensuring continuity of engagement while prioritising health, safety, and accessibility.

As restrictions eased, the Council progressively reintroduced physical and hybrid events, adopting improved planning methodologies, strengthened branding, enhanced digital integration, and greater alignment with strategic objectives. Over time, PSCBC events evolved from largely operational gatherings into strategically positioned platforms that supported governance, labour relations, capacity building, stakeholder collaboration, and public sector thought leadership.

7.4.2. Strategic Achievements

Throughout the five-year period, the PSCBC successfully sustained its events programme despite significant external challenges. One of the most notable achievements was the Council's swift adaptation to virtual and electronic conferencing platforms during the pandemic. This ensured uninterrupted hosting of meetings, workshops, stakeholder engagements, and commemorative events, while expanding accessibility to participants across provinces.

The Council strengthened the quality and professionalism of its events through improved planning, coordination, and execution. Events increasingly reflected a unified PSCBC brand, with enhanced communication, improved stakeholder experience, and consistent messaging aligned to the Council's mandate and strategic priorities. This contributed to the strengthening of the PSCBC's public image and institutional credibility.

The PSCBC hosted and supported several high-impact strategic events, including public service summits, stakeholder dialogues, youth empowerment initiatives, commemorative events, and collaborative engagements with sector bargaining councils and international organisations. These events provided platforms for dialogue on labour relations, public service delivery, capacity development, and social responsibility, reinforcing the Council's leadership role within the public service bargaining landscape.

Hybrid events introduced during the latter part of the period enabled broader participation while maintaining cost efficiency. The integration of digital tools improved event registration, attendance tracking, information dissemination, and post-event reporting, enhancing overall operational effectiveness.

Leadership visibility at events increased significantly over the period, reinforcing accountability, stakeholder confidence, and strategic alignment. The involvement of senior management and Council leadership ensured that events were not merely ceremonial but contributed meaningfully to strategic outcomes.

7.4.3 Key Challenges Experienced

Despite the successes achieved, the PSCBC events programme faced several challenges over the five-year period. The COVID-19 pandemic posed substantial operational constraints, including limitations on physical gatherings, reduced budgets, and logistical complexities associated with virtual platforms. The rapid transition to digital events required accelerated skills development and placed pressure on existing ICT and communications capacity.

Financial constraints remained a persistent challenge, particularly as the cost of hosting high-quality hybrid and physical events increased in a constrained economic environment. Balancing cost containment with stakeholder expectations and event quality required careful planning and prioritisation.

Logistical challenges were also experienced in coordinating multi-stakeholder events, particularly those involving multiple bargaining councils, external partners, or international delegations. These challenges included scheduling complexities, varying technological capabilities among participants, and ensuring consistent engagement in virtual environments.

The absence of a fully standardised monitoring and evaluation framework for events limited the ability to consistently measure impact beyond attendance figures. While qualitative feedback was positive, the need for more structured post-event assessments became evident to strengthen learning and continuous improvement.

7.4.4 Strategic Lessons and Evolution

The five-year period provided valuable lessons that informed the evolution of the PSCBC's events strategy. The importance of flexibility, digital readiness, and proactive planning emerged as critical success factors. The Council recognised that events must be outcome-driven, strategically aligned, and supported by robust planning, communication, and evaluation mechanisms.

The integration of events planning with ICT and communications functions strengthened coordination, branding, and stakeholder reach. This integration positioned the PSCBC to leverage technology more effectively and adopt innovative approaches to engagement in line with Fourth Industrial Revolution (4IR) principles.

7.4.5 Conclusion

In conclusion, the PSCBC's events programme over the five-year strategic period demonstrated resilience, adaptability, and progressive maturation. Despite operating in a volatile and resource-constrained environment, the Council successfully leveraged events as strategic tools to support its mandate, strengthen stakeholder relationships, and enhance organisational visibility.

Going forward, the PSCBC is well positioned to further professionalise its events management function, strengthen impact measurement, and harness technology to deliver inclusive, cost-effective, and strategically aligned events that contribute meaningfully to the Council's long-term objectives.

7.5 Corporate Social Responsibility

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has remained a critical pillar of the PSCBC's broader mandate to promote social justice, dignity, and sustainable development within South African communities. Over the five-year period under review, the Council consistently aligned its CSR initiatives with national priorities, humanitarian needs, and the values embodied by public service, ubuntu, and inclusivity.

The CSR programme evolved significantly over the period, transitioning from emergency humanitarian relief during the COVID-19 pandemic to structured, developmental, and empowerment-focused interventions aimed at education, youth development, skills transfer, and community sustainability. Despite operating in a constrained socio-economic environment, the PSCBC demonstrated resilience, adaptability, and commitment to leaving a meaningful and lasting legacy in the communities it serves.

7.5.1 Strategic Objectives Of The CSR Programme

Over the five-year period, the PSCBC's CSR initiatives were guided by the following strategic objectives:

- To provide timely humanitarian relief in response to national crises and emergencies
- To support vulnerable and marginalised communities, particularly children, youth, the elderly, and persons with disabilities
- To promote education, skills development, and youth empowerment
- To contribute to sustainable community development rather than once-off charitable interventions
- To honour the legacy of Nelson Mandela through consistent, values-driven community engagement

7.5.2. Key Achievements

7.5.2.1. Emergency Response and Frontline Support

The 2020/21 financial year was dominated by the COVID-19 pandemic, which required an urgent and compassionate response. The PSCBC demonstrated decisive leadership by prioritising frontline healthcare workers and vulnerable communities.

Significant achievements included the donation of medical equipment, masks, and sanitising supplies to the Olievenhoutbosch Clinic in Pretoria, as well as PPEs, mattresses, and blankets to the 10th Commandments Community Care Centre in Tembisa. These interventions directly supported healthcare delivery and rehabilitation services during a period of unprecedented strain.

The Council's support was acknowledged by beneficiary institutions, reinforcing the PSCBC's role as a socially responsive organisation. This year laid the foundation for long-term relationships with adopted community organisations, particularly within the health and rehabilitation sectors.

Key Outcome:

The PSCBC established itself as a trusted and responsive partner during a national health crisis, directly supporting frontline workers and impoverished communities.

7.5.2.2. Expanded Reach and Crisis Intervention

In 2021/22, the CSR programme expanded in scale and geographic reach through strategic partnerships. A notable milestone was the collaboration with the GPSSBC to distribute 20,000 face masks to 30 Non-Profit Organisations across the country, focusing on organisations serving women, children, the elderly, and persons with disabilities.

The year was further marked by the Council's response to the July 2021 civil unrest, particularly in KwaZulu-Natal. Through a partnership with Gift of the Givers Foundation, the PSCBC contributed food parcels and essential goods to underprivileged communities and old-age homes affected by severe food shortages.

In addition, the Council broadened its CSR focus to youth development through participation in the Tracker's Tomorrow's Man Programme, exposing learners to career opportunities, mentorship, and digital skills. The donation of tablets and virtual engagement sessions reflected adaptability in a pandemic-affected education environment.

Mandela Commemoration initiatives included structural repairs to the Louis Botha Orphanage, addressing health and safety risks and improving living conditions for vulnerable children.

Key outcome:

The PSCBC transitioned from emergency relief to a balanced approach incorporating humanitarian aid, youth empowerment, and infrastructure development.

7.5.2.3. Sustainability, Empowerment and Long-Term Impact

The 2022/23 period marked a strategic shift towards sustainable empowerment initiatives. A flagship success was the PSCBC's continued support of African Mamas Crafts, culminating in the opening of their first physical retail store at Emperors Palace. This achievement demonstrated the Council's ability to facilitate economic empowerment, job creation, and long-term sustainability for rural women entrepreneurs.

Ongoing refurbishment projects at the Louis Botha Children's Home and the 10th Commandments Community Care Centre reinforced the PSCBC's commitment to adopted organisations through phased, long-term interventions rather than once-off donations.

The Council also strengthened its international and stakeholder engagement through hosting the Public Service International (PSI) delegation, reinforcing solidarity with frontline public service workers globally.

Mandela Commemoration activities extended to Leamogetswe Safety Home, focusing on holistic care for orphaned and vulnerable children.

Key outcome:

CSR interventions matured into legacy projects with measurable social and economic impact.

7.5.2.4. Structured Development and Community Resilience

In 2023/24, the PSCBC formalised its youth empowerment efforts through the launch of the Development and Empowerment Programme (DEP). This programme provided structured exposure to the world of work, career guidance, and skills awareness for Grade 12 learners, reflecting a strategic investment in future public service capacity.

The Council also responded swiftly to the Marshalltown fire tragedy by coordinating a food and clothing drive for affected families, demonstrating compassion and solidarity during a national disaster.

Mandela Day initiatives continued to focus on the 10th Commandments Community Care Centre, with infrastructure upgrades and the introduction of skills development workshops facilitated by African Mamas Crafts, reinforcing self-reliance among rehabilitated youth.

Mandela Commemoration Day activities at the Mamelodi Old Age Home highlighted the Council's intergenerational approach to community care.

Key outcome

CSR initiatives became more programmatic, combining relief, empowerment, and skills development into an integrated model.

7.5.2.5. Education, Dignity and Inclusive Development

The 2024/25 financial year reflected a strong emphasis on education, dignity, and child development. The School Shoes and Sanitary Towel Drive at Gatang Secondary School directly addressed barriers to learning and learner dignity, benefiting over 100 learners.

Mandela Commemoration initiatives at the Little Rose Centre in Eldorado Park reinforced the PSCBC's focus on child welfare, nutrition, and psychosocial well-being, with direct engagement from staff and leadership.

The donation of stationery and toys to ML Lethabo Children's Home further underscored the Council's commitment to education and early childhood development, with visible leadership involvement reinforcing accountability and organisational values.

Key outcome:

The PSCBC consolidated its CSR identity as an organisation committed to dignity, education, and sustainable community upliftment.

7.5.3. Overall Achievements

- Sustained and visible commitment to CSR despite national crises and economic constraints

- Successful transition from emergency relief to sustainable development and empowerment initiatives
- Long-term adoption and support of key community institutions
- Strong alignment of CSR activities with Mandela legacy values
- Effective collaboration with stakeholders, NGOs, and bargaining councils
- Increased leadership and staff participation, strengthening organisational culture and ownership

7.5.4. Key Challenges Experienced

- Limited financial resources in the context of increasing community needs
- Logistical constraints during periods of lockdown, unrest, and emergencies
- High demand for support often exceeding available capacity
- The need for more formal impact measurement frameworks to quantify long-term outcomes

7.5.5. Strategic Lessons and Way Forward

The five-year period demonstrated that consistent, values-driven CSR interventions yield sustainable impact when supported by partnerships, planning, and leadership commitment. Going forward, the PSCBC is well-positioned to:

- Strengthen monitoring and evaluation of CSR impact
- Leverage technology and digital platforms to amplify outreach
- Integrate CSR more closely with youth development, education, and skills transfer
- Continue building long-term relationships with adopted organisations

7.5.6 Conclusion

The PSCBC's Corporate Social Responsibility programme over the past five years reflects a steadfast commitment to social justice, community empowerment, and nation-building. Through compassion, strategic foresight, and collaborative action, the Council has not only responded to

immediate needs but has also contributed to sustainable change and enduring community resilience.

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

7.6 Overview

Over the past five years, the Information and Communication Technology (ICT) function at the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) has undergone a substantial and strategic transformation. This period was marked by rapid technological advancement, the unprecedented disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic, escalating cybersecurity threats, and increasing demands for flexible and digitally enabled ways of work.

Throughout this period, the ICT Unit played a central enabling role in sustaining the Council's operations, safeguarding information assets, and modernising the technological environment. The evolution from a predominantly on-premise infrastructure to a secure, cloud-based and resilient ICT ecosystem reflects a deliberate strategic shift aimed at strengthening organisational performance and long-term sustainability.

7.7.1 Strategic Context and Objectives

The ICT strategy over the five-year period was guided by the need to ensure uninterrupted business operations while modernising systems and strengthening governance. The primary focus was on maintaining system availability, improving operational efficiency, enabling remote and hybrid work, strengthening cybersecurity controls, and aligning ICT practices with legislative and regulatory requirements, including the Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA). ICT was positioned not merely as a support function, but as a strategic enabler of the Council's mandate.

7.7.2. Strategic Progress Over the Five-Year Period

7.7.2.1. Foundation and Pandemic Response

The 2020/21 financial year represented a foundational period for ICT modernisation and an immediate test of organisational resilience. As the COVID-19 pandemic disrupted traditional working arrangements, the ICT Unit implemented urgent interventions to ensure continuity of

operations. Core systems were stabilised through the virtualisation of servers, upgrades to critical applications, and the strengthening of backup and recovery capabilities.

A significant improvement in connectivity was achieved through the replacement of limited ADSL infrastructure with high-speed fibre connectivity, enabling more reliable access to systems and online services. In parallel, security controls were enhanced through the implementation of next-generation firewall technology, strengthened email security, and improved access controls.

The rapid adoption of remote work required the introduction of new infrastructure, including VPN access, additional servers, employee laptops, and a hosted VoIP telephony solution. While these interventions ensured continuity, they also highlighted challenges relating to unplanned expenditure, load shedding, and the constraints of legacy infrastructure.

7.7.2.2. Stabilisation and Hybrid Enablement

During 2021/22, the ICT focus shifted from emergency response to stabilisation and optimisation. The infrastructure enhancements introduced during the pandemic were consolidated, and system reliability and security were further strengthened. The ICT environment increasingly supported hybrid working arrangements, reflecting changes in organisational operations and stakeholder engagement.

The period also saw increased emphasis on digital enablement and skills development, particularly in support of hybrid meetings, online engagement platforms, and internal digital communication tools. While progress was achieved, challenges remained in ensuring consistent user adoption and balancing operational demands with ongoing system improvements.

7.7.2.3. Cybersecurity Crisis and Strategic Transformation

The February 2023 ransomware cyber-attack represented a critical turning point in the Council's ICT journey. The attack disrupted core operational systems and necessitated the temporary suspension of dispute management processes. In response, a coordinated and structured recovery approach was implemented, encompassing legal and regulatory compliance, data recovery, and business continuity planning.

All statutory obligations were met through engagement with law enforcement agencies and notification of the Information Regulator in accordance with POPIA. Data recovery efforts resulted in the substantial restoration of systems, including case management, email, and user data. Importantly, the incident accelerated a strategic shift towards cloud-based services, significantly reducing reliance on on-premise infrastructure and improving resilience.

By the end of the recovery period, systems were declared ransomware-free, critical operations were restored, and the Council emerged with a markedly stronger security posture and improved disaster recovery capability.

7.7.2.4. Cloud Consolidation and Service Optimisation

Following the cyber-attack, 2023/24 focused on consolidating the transition to a cloud-integrated ICT environment. The full adoption of Microsoft 365 transformed collaboration, communication, and productivity across the organisation. Financial and administrative systems were migrated to web-based platforms, improving accessibility and operational efficiency.

User support services were strengthened to ensure continuity and responsiveness, while security controls were further enhanced through centrally managed endpoint protection and secure printing solutions to support POPIA compliance. Network capacity was expanded through increased fibre bandwidth, infrastructure upgrades following building renovations, and improvements to wireless connectivity.

Investment in skills development and capacity building supported these changes, ensuring that staff were equipped to operate effectively within the modernised digital environment.

7.7.2.5. Governance, Resilience and Modernisation

The 2024/25 period was characterised by a focus on governance, sustainability, and refinement of the ICT operating environment. A comprehensive updated ICT Policy was developed to strengthen governance, clarify user responsibilities, and align ICT operations with best practices.

Targeted infrastructure investments were made to support hybrid engagement, including upgrades to boardroom audio-visual systems and user devices approaching end-of-life. Network and endpoint security continued to be actively monitored, with real-time threat detection and response capabilities maintained.

In addition, backup and disaster recovery arrangements were strengthened through offsite storage and the development of an updated Disaster Recovery Plan, reinforcing the Council's overall business continuity framework.

7.7.3 Overall Achievements

Across the five-year period, the ICT Unit successfully transformed the Council's technology environment into a secure, resilient, and modern digital platform. The Council demonstrated the ability to respond effectively to major disruptions, including a global pandemic and a significant cyber-attack, while simultaneously modernising systems and improving service delivery. Network performance, cybersecurity, user productivity, and governance frameworks were all substantially enhanced.

7.7.4 Challenges and Lessons Learned

The period under review underscored the increasing complexity of the ICT risk environment, particularly in relation to cybersecurity threats and resource constraints. It also highlighted the importance of proactive planning, continuous skills development, and strong governance frameworks. Key lessons include the critical role of cloud-based solutions in enabling resilience, the necessity of proactive cybersecurity measures, and the importance of tested business continuity arrangements.

7.7.5 Conclusion

The transformation of the PSCBC's ICT environment over the past five years represents a significant strategic achievement. The Council is now supported by a modern, secure, and scalable ICT platform that is well positioned to support its mandate and adapt to future challenges. Continued investment in governance, cybersecurity, skills development, and innovation will be essential to sustain this progress and ensure that ICT remains a strategic enabler of organisational performance.

7.7 Proposed ICT Unit Theme

"Enabling a Secure, Integrated and Digitally Responsive PSCBC"

This theme reflects the ICT Unit's evolution from a support function into a strategic enabler of the PSCBC's mandate. It captures the integration of communications and information technology, the emphasis on security and resilience following the cyberattack, and the need for digital responsiveness in stakeholder engagement, service delivery, and governance

7.7.1. What the PSCBC Should Expect From The ICT Unit

The ICT Unit is expected to:

- Enable stable, secure, and uninterrupted operations, even during periods of crisis or disruption
- Serve as the custodian of the PSCBC brand, ensuring consistency across digital, media, and physical platforms
- Provide reliable, compliant, and resilient ICT systems that support hybrid work, dispute management, and stakeholder engagement
- Proactively anticipate technological risks and opportunities, rather than responding reactively
- Strengthen digital visibility, accessibility, and credibility of the Council at national and international levels
- Embed data, analytics, and performance measurement into communication, ICT, and decision-making processes
- Support leadership and Council structures with modern, secure, and efficient digital tools

In essence, the ICT Unit should be seen as a strategic partner, not merely a technical or communications support function

7.7.2. Strategic Objectives of the ICT Unit

7.7.2.1. Strengthen ICT Governance, Security and Resilience

To ensure a secure, compliant, and resilient ICT environment that protects the Council's information assets, supports business continuity, and mitigates cyber and operational risks.

Key focus areas:

- Cybersecurity and POPIA compliance
- Disaster recovery and business continuity planning
- Policy implementation, risk management, and governance oversight

Position ICT as a Strategic Enabler of the PSCBC Mandate

To align ICT planning, systems, and innovations directly with the Council's strategic objectives, operational needs, and service-delivery responsibilities.

Key focus areas:

- Integration of ICT with organisational strategy
- Digital enablement of collective bargaining and dispute processes
- Support for hybrid and remote working environments

7.7.2.2. Enhance Digital Communication, Visibility and Brand Integrity

To strengthen the PSCBC's public profile through coordinated digital platforms that deliver clear, consistent, and credible messaging.

Key focus areas:

- Website as the single source of truth
- Integrated social media and digital communication strategies
- Brand consistency across events, CSR, media, and digital platforms
-

7.7.2.3. Drive Digital Innovation and Continuous Improvement

To move beyond system maintenance toward innovation that improves efficiency, accessibility, and stakeholder experience.

Key focus areas:

- Cloud optimisation and system modernisation
- User experience enhancement and platform interactivity
- Adoption of emerging technologies aligned with 4IR principles
- Artificial intelligence

Strengthen Data, Analytics and Performance Measurement

To support evidence-based decision-making through reliable data, analytics, and reporting across ICT, communications, events, and CSR.

Key focus areas:

- Website and social media analytics
- Impact measurement frameworks for events and CSR
- Improved data quality, validation, and reporting controls

Build ICT Capacity and Institutional Sustainability

To ensure that ICT capability, skills, and institutional knowledge are sustained and strengthened over time.

Key focus areas:

- Skills development and change management
- Vendor and service-provider oversight
- Reducing dependency on reactive and ad-hoc interventions

7.8. Strategic Positioning Statement

“The ICT Unit will enable a secure, integrated and digitally responsive PSCBC by aligning technology, communication, and innovation with the Council’s mandate, ensuring resilience, visibility, and sustainable organisational performance.”

7.9 Conclusion

The Communications function has played a vital role in strengthening stakeholder engagement, enhancing organisational visibility, and supporting the effective dissemination of information across the PSCBC and its stakeholders. Through communication initiatives supporting dispute resolution processes, research dissemination, training programmes, and strategic events, the function has contributed to improved transparency, stakeholder awareness, and institutional credibility. These efforts have ensured that stakeholders remain informed and aligned with Council developments and strategic priorities. Going forward, continued investment in digital communication platforms and targeted stakeholder engagement will be critical in further strengthening the PSCBC’s reputation and supporting its mandate.



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